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WELFARE MEASURES FOR DEPARTMENTAL EMPLOYEES AND GRAMIN DAK SEVAKS (GDS)

Complete, Verified and Updated Study Notes

LDCE — Inspector Posts | PS Group 'B' | AAO | PM / MTS / PA-SA

SECOND (REVISED) EDITION

Incorporating the revised Circle Welfare Fund for Gramin Dak Sevaks (CWFGDS)
notified vide D.o.P. O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.02.2026

EDITION, CURRENCY AND DISCLAIMER

EDITION AND CURRENCY

Second (Revised) Edition — legal position stated as on July 2026.

This edition incorporates the completely revised Circle Welfare Fund for Gramin Dak Sevaks (CWFGDS) notified by the Department of Posts vide O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.02.2026, which supersedes the earlier CWFGDS scheme circulated vide O.M. of even number dated 11.09.2024.

It also incorporates the revision of the departmental welfare schemes agreed at the 13th meeting of the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board held on 11.11.2025 and conveyed vide O.M. No. 1-01/2024-Wl&Sps dated 22.12.2025, with effect from 1st April 2026.

Every monetary figure, ceiling, percentage, time-limit and date in these notes has been checked against the text of the order that fixes it, including the annexures to both orders. Each is cited by paragraph so that the reader can verify it independently.

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In the event of any difference between these notes and the original order, THE ORIGINAL ORDER SHALL PREVAIL. Welfare rates, ceilings and eligibility conditions are revised from time to time by the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board and the Directorate; readers must confirm the position obtaining on the date of use.

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HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

This booklet covers the entire welfare architecture of the Department of Posts — the boards that run it, the funds that finance it, and every individual welfare benefit available to a departmental employee and to a Gramin Dak Sevak. It is arranged so that a first reading builds the framework, and later readings can be restricted to the tables and the revision capsule at the end.

The subject is examined almost entirely on **figures, ceilings, percentages, time-limits and competent authorities**. Narrative understanding alone will not fetch marks. Therefore every scheme in these notes is presented in a fixed four-part shape — **what the benefit is → how much → who is eligible → which authority sanctions it** — so that the examinable quantity is always visible at a glance.

The Verification Flags Used in This Booklet

Because welfare rates change frequently, and older rates continue to circulate in coaching material long after they have been superseded, every substantive figure in this booklet carries a currency status. The flags mean:

Flag	Meaning	How you should treat it
VERIFIED	Traced to, and reproduced from, the text of a currently in-force Department of Posts order, with the paragraph of that order cited alongside.	Safe to learn and to quote in the examination.
○ UNREVISED	The figure is in force, but it was NOT touched by the revision of 22.12.2025. It survives under Para VII of that order, which preserves all terms and conditions not expressly revised.	Fully operative. Learn it. Know that its authority is an older instrument.
✕ SUPERSEDED	The figure was correct earlier but has been replaced. It is retained only so that you can recognise and reject it as a wrong option in an MCQ.	Never quote as the current position.

Legend of currency flags used throughout this booklet.

This edition carries **no ▲ UNCONFIRMED flags at all**. Both governing orders — the departmental revision of 22.12.2025 and the revised CWFGDS of 11.02.2026 — have been read in full, together with every annexure to both, and every figure in this booklet has been checked against the text of the order that fixes it.

WHY THIS EDITION EXISTS

Two orders in quick succession rewrote this entire topic, and earlier editions of these notes predate both of them.

The Postal Services Staff Welfare Board met for its 13th sitting on 11.11.2025. The revisions it agreed were conveyed vide O.M. No. 1-01/2024-Wl&Sps dated 22.12.2025, effective 1st April 2026, and they lifted almost every departmental rate — death relief, illness and surgery, all five academic-excellence awards, the whole education scholarship table, the SC/ST/OBC scholarship, the specially-abled child benefits, the RWA grant, the excursion trip and the holiday homes.

Separately, the Department issued a fresh consolidated CWFGDS on 11.02.2026 which superseded the GDS scheme of 11.09.2024 in its entirety — doubling the loan ceiling to ₹1,00,000, introducing a concessional electric-vehicle loan at 3%, raising the mobile/tablet limit, and rewriting the bye-laws and the terms and conditions.

Part 6 sets out, item by item, exactly what changed — including two places where an earlier edition of these notes had the figures attached to the wrong rows, and one place where an earlier correction of ours was itself mistaken and has now been withdrawn.



PART 1 – THE WELFARE FRAMEWORK OF THE DEPARTMENT OF POSTS

1.1 Why the Department Maintains a Separate Welfare Structure

The Department of Posts is one of the largest civilian employers in the country, with a workforce spread from metropolitan Head Post Offices down to single-handed Branch Post Offices in remote villages. A very large proportion of that workforce — the Gramin Dak Sevaks — are not Central Government servants in the ordinary sense: they are engaged under a separate set of conditions and are outside most of the service benefits available to regular Government employees.

Ordinary Government-wide welfare provisions (CGHS, CGEGIS, pension, leave rules and so on) therefore either do not reach, or do not adequately reach, a substantial part of the postal workforce. To bridge that gap the Department maintains its own welfare machinery, funded partly by the Government and partly by the employees themselves, which delivers targeted assistance at the moment of crisis — a death in the family, a major surgery, a house destroyed by flood, a child's education, an accident on duty.

This welfare machinery is administered by the Welfare & Sports Section of the Postal Directorate, under the policy direction of the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board.

1.2 Two Parallel Streams — The Single Most Important Distinction

The welfare scheme of Gramin Dak Sevaks was **bifurcated** from that of departmental employees, and a separate GDS scheme was issued vide letter No. 19-31/2012-WL & Sports dated 17.09.2013. Since then the two streams have run in parallel, with different funds, different rates, different eligibility conditions and different sanctioning arrangements.

Nearly every mistake made in this topic — in the examination and in the office — comes from applying a departmental rate to a GDS or vice versa.

Point of comparison	Departmental Employees	Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)
Governing fund	Circle Welfare Fund (CWF) / Central Welfare Fund of the Directorate	Circle Welfare Fund for Gramin Dak Sevaks (CWFGDS)
Present governing instrument	Consolidated welfare scheme orders of the Welfare & Sports Section, as revised from time to time by the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board	O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.02.2026
Character of the scheme	Non-contributory so far as the individual employee is concerned; financed from Government grant and Circle Welfare Fund receipts	Contributory — mandatory monthly subscription by every GDS, plus grant-in-aid from the Central Postal Welfare Fund

Point of comparison	Departmental Employees	Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)
Individual subscription	Nil	₹40 per month (₹480 per annum), recovered in one lump sum in April from the TRCA of March
Central grant-in-aid	From the Central Welfare Fund of the Directorate	₹200 per GDS per year to each Circle, annually and on a recurring basis
Retirement benefit for non-claimants	Not available	Available — graded one-time payment on discharge if no assistance was ever claimed
Repayable loan facility	Not part of this scheme	Available — up to ₹1,00,000 at 5% or 3% simple interest
Final authority on grants	Head of Circle	Head of Region for cases within the Region; Head of Circle is the coordinating and final authority for the Circle

Table 1.1 — The two welfare streams contrasted. Learn this table before anything else.

1.3 The Administrative Machinery

(a) Postal Services Staff Welfare Board (PSSWB) — Central Level

The PSSWB is the apex policy body for staff welfare in the Department. It reviews the working of all welfare schemes, sanctions revisions in rates and ceilings, and directs the framing of bye-laws for the Circle Welfare Funds. Its composition is:

Position on the Board	Held by
Chairman	Hon'ble Minister of Communications
Vice-Chairman	Chairman, Postal Services Board
Executive Vice-Chairman	Director General (Postal Services)
Secretary of the Board	Director (Welfare & Sports), Postal Directorate
Members	Officers of the Directorate, representatives of the Circles and recognised service unions / federations, and nominated members representing different cadres

Table 1.2 — Composition of the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board.

Note for revision: **the 12th meeting of the PSSWB was held on 22.08.2017**, and the decisions taken there were circulated as the general revision of welfare schemes vide O.M. No. 1-01/2017-WL & Sports dated 30.01.2018 — the order from which a very large number of the departmental rates in Part 3 of these notes are derived. The **13th meeting** of the Board was held on **11.11.2025** at the Conference Hall, Block No. 10, Jodhpur Hostel, New Delhi,

again under the Chairmanship of the Hon'ble Minister of Communications. The revisions agreed at that meeting were conveyed vide O.M. No. 1-01/2024-Wl&Sps dated **22.12.2025**, with effect from **1st April 2026**. That order is the source of every current departmental rate in Part 3 of these notes.

(b) Circle Welfare Board – Circle Level

Each Postal Circle has its own Welfare Board which implements the schemes locally and administers the Circle Welfare Fund. Its composition is:

Position	Held by
President	Head of the Circle (Chief Postmaster General)
Vice-President	Any officer nominated by the President
Secretary	Welfare Officer of the Circle
Members	Officers of the Circle Office and representatives of the recognised service unions

Table 1.3 – Composition of the Circle Welfare Board.

(c) Postal Sports Board

Sports activity is administered separately through the Postal Sports Board and the Circle Sports Boards, financed from the Sports Fund. Although welfare and sports are handled by the same Section of the Directorate – the Welfare & Sports Section – the funds are distinct and grants of one cannot be met from the other.

1.4 Sources of the Welfare Funds

- Government grant released annually by the Directorate to the Circles from the Central Welfare Fund.
- For the GDS stream, the compulsory subscription recovered from every regularly engaged GDS.
- Grant-in-aid of ₹200 per GDS per year released from the Central Welfare Fund to each Circle.
- Donations, contributions and other collections received and credited to the Fund with the approval of the competent authority.
- Interest earned on the balances of the Fund, which is kept in a separate savings account.

The Circles are required to submit two separate statements when rendering accounts – one in respect of the funds received as Government grant, and the other relating to the total amount credited to the Fund from all sources including the Government grant.

1.5 Nodal Authorities — Who Does What

Level	Authority	Principal welfare role
Central	Minister of Communications	Chairman, PSSWB — approves policy and revision of rates
Central	Director General (Postal Services)	Executive Vice-Chairman, PSSWB; holds the power to make changes in the scope of the CWFGDS scheme
Central	Director (Welfare & Sports)	Secretary of the Board; issues the welfare orders and Office Memoranda
Circle	Chief Postmaster General	President, Circle Welfare Board; controls the Circle Welfare Fund and the CWFGDS; final and coordinating authority on all welfare grants in the Circle
Region	Regional Postmaster General	Operates the Regional share of the GDS Fund; final authority for deciding GDS financial-grant cases arising in the Region
Division	Divisional Head (SSPOs / SPOs / SSRM / SRM)	Verifies and forwards applications with a clear “Recommended” or “Not recommended” endorsement and brief justification
Head Post Office	Accounts Branch of the HO	Recovers the GDS subscription, maintains the register of members, remits collections to the Treasurer of the Managing Committee

Table 1.4 — Welfare responsibilities by level.

PART 2 — FIELD SERVICE (POSTAL) BENEVOLENT FUND

This is a small but frequently examined fund, and it is quite distinct from the Circle Welfare Fund. It exists for postal personnel serving with the Army Postal Service (APS), that is, for those who are exposed to field-service conditions along with the armed forces.

Who is covered

- Group 'C' employees of the Department of Posts who are on deputation to the Army Postal Service.
- The benefit under this Fund is a ONE-TIME benefit — it cannot be claimed repeatedly.

Scale of assistance

Description of welfare benefit	Amount
Financial assistance in the case of normal death	₹ 3,500
Financial assistance in the case of death due to enemy action in insurgency operations	₹ 25,000
One-time scholarship for each school-going and college-going child of the deceased	₹ 500

Table 2.1 — Field Service (Postal) Benevolent Fund. ◦ Unrevised — this Fund was not among the schemes revised on 22.12.2025, and the rates continue as before.

EXAMINATION POINTERS

- The “enemy action in insurgency operations” rate (₹25,000) is the distinguishing figure of this Fund. Do not confuse it with the terrorist-activity rates under the Circle Welfare Fund, which are far higher.
- The scholarship of ₹500 is per child, one time, and is not a monthly rate.
- Eligibility is tied to deputation at APS, not to service in a Circle.

PART 3 — WELFARE SCHEMES FOR DEPARTMENTAL EMPLOYEES

THE GOVERNING ORDER FOR THIS PART — LEARN THIS CITATION

No. 1-01/2024-Wl&Sps, Government of India, Ministry of Communications, Department of Posts (Welfare & Sports Section), Dak Bhawan, Sansad Marg, New Delhi – 110001, dated 22.12.2025 — “Revision in Welfare Schemes for Departmental Employee / GDS”.

It conveys the amendments and revisions agreed to by the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board at its 13th Meeting held on 11.11.2025 at the Conference Hall, Block No. 10, Jodhpur Hostel, New Delhi, under the Chairmanship of the Hon’ble Minister of Communications.

The revisions take effect WITH EFFECT FROM 1st APRIL 2026. Since that date has passed, every revised rate in this Part is the rate now in force.

The order is signed by (Sunita), Director (Welfare and Sports) & Secretary of the PSSWB, and was circulated by (Ankit Panwar), Section Officer (Welfare and Sports).

Para VII of the order provides that ALL OTHER EXISTING TERMS AND CONDITIONS WILL REMAIN UNCHANGED. That single sentence is what keeps the older rates alive for every scheme the order did not touch.

The order revises seven groups of schemes. Everything it revises is marked in the pages that follow, and is shown with the existing rate alongside the revised rate, because examiners set questions on both. Everything the order did not touch continues at its earlier rate by force of Para VII, and is marked **○ UNREVISED** — meaning the figure is still operative, but its authority is an older instrument rather than the 2025 revision.

What the 22.12.2025 order REVISED	What it left UNTOUCHED (still in force under Para VII)
Financial assistance on death of departmental employees — all four situations	Assistance in natural calamities, fire and floods
Assistance for serious illness and major surgical operations — both departmental employees and GDS	Nutritional assistance for tuberculosis
Incentive for academic excellence — all five positions	Assistance during EOL and HPL on account of prolonged illness
Financial assistance under the education scheme for children of departmental employees	Mobility aids — tricycle, artificial limb, travel to the limb centre
Scholarship for SC / ST / OBC employees — departmental examinations and higher education	Hostel and mess subsidy for specially abled children
Scholarship and transport charges for specially abled children	Scholarship for the UPSC examination

What the 22.12.2025 order REVISED	What it left UNTOUCHED (still in force under Para VII)
Grant-in-aid to Residents' Welfare Associations, with fresh conditions at Annexure-B	Scholarship for development of individual personality
Excursion trip — radius and rate of subsidy	Grants to the CPLO, recreation clubs, crèches and tailoring classes
Holiday homes — rent, and the ceilings on furnishing and upkeep	Field Service (Postal) Benevolent Fund

Table 3.0 — Scope of the revision of 22.12.2025. Knowing which side of this line a scheme falls on is itself an examinable point.



3.1 Financial Assistance in the Case of Death

This is the most heavily examined item in the whole topic, because four different situations attract four different rates, and the GDS rate differs from the departmental rate in every one of them. The four situations are distinguished by two questions: was the death caused by an attack by robbers, terrorists or rioters, or by an accident, or was it a normal death; and was the employee on duty at the time?

(a) Departmental employees — as revised with effect from 01.04.2026

Sl.	Scheme	Old provision	New provision
1	Immediate death relief	₹ 10,000	₹ 25,000
2	Death due to accident while ON duty	₹ 15,000	₹ 35,000
3	Death due to attack by robbers, terrorists, riots etc. while ON duty	₹ 75,000	₹ 1,10,000
4	Death due to attack by robbers, terrorists, riots etc. while NOT on duty	₹ 15,000	₹ 35,000

Table 3.1 — Para I of the order dated 22.12.2025. The order records that the existing provisions flowed from letter No. 2-1/2001-WL/Sports dated 26.04.2002, No. 1-01/2009-WL/Sports dated 19.03.2013, No. 1-3/99-WL/SPT dated 01.06.2000 and letter No. 1-01/2017-WL & Sports dated 31.01.2018.

(b) The two streams side by side

Situation in which death occurs	Departmental Employee	Gramin Dak Sevak
Immediate assistance on death — for GDS, irrespective of whether the death occurs during duty hours or outside duty hours	₹ 25,000	₹ 11,000
Death due to attack by robbers, terrorists, riots or extremist activity WHILE ON DUTY	₹ 1,10,000	₹ 1,65,000
Death caused by robbers, terrorists, riots or extremist activity WHILE NOT ON DUTY	₹ 35,000	₹ 13,200
Death WHILE ON DUTY due to an accident	₹ 35,000	₹ 27,500
Funeral expenses — payable where the last rites are performed by brothers, sisters or near relatives in the absence of any other next of kin	Not provided under this head	₹ 5,500

Table 3.2 — Death assistance, both streams. Departmental figures from Para I of the order dated 22.12.2025; GDS figures from Para 14.1 of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026.

THE TRAP IN THIS TABLE

For death by attack while on duty, the GDS rate (₹1,65,000) is HIGHER than the departmental rate (₹1,10,000). This is the one place where the GDS benefit exceeds the departmental benefit, and examiners return to it repeatedly.

In every other line of the table the departmental rate is the higher one.

Note the symmetry inside the departmental column: ₹35,000 is the answer both for death by accident on duty AND for death by attack while not on duty. Before the revision these two were also identical, at ₹15,000.

Funeral expenses remain a GDS-only head, payable only in the narrow circumstance described.

3.2 Financial Assistance in Cases of Natural Calamities, Fire and Floods

Where the residence or belongings of an employee are destroyed or seriously damaged by a natural calamity such as fire, flood, cyclone or earthquake, assistance is payable from the Circle Welfare Fund. This head was NOT revised by the order of 22.12.2025 and therefore continues unchanged under Para VII of that order.

Category	Amount
Departmental employee	₹ 4,500 ○ Unrevised
Gramin Dak Sevak	₹ 5,500

Table 3.3 — Natural calamity assistance. The GDS figure is verified at Para 14.1(13) of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026. Some secondary summaries of that order state ₹7,500 for GDS; the text of the order itself reads ₹5,500, and the order has been preferred.

3.3 Serious Illness and Major Surgical Operations

The order describes this head as financial assistance in cases of proven exceptional hardship relating to serious illness and major surgical operations, and records that the assistance was increased unanimously by the PSSWB for BOTH departmental employees and GDS, so as to provide more substantial support to employees facing prolonged illness, surgical operations or major surgery. The ailments contemplated are those such as cancer, brain haemorrhage, kidney failure or transplant and heart surgery.

Category	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Departmental Employees	₹ 10,000	₹ 15,000
Gramin Dak Sevaks	₹ 22,000	₹ 30,000

Table 3.4 — Para II of the order dated 22.12.2025. The existing provisions are traced by the order to Directorate letter No. 15-43/92-WL & Sports dated 02.09.1992, letter No. 10-31/98-WL & Sports dated 11.03.1999, letter No. 19-31/2012-WL/Sps dated 17.09.2013 and O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sps dated 11.09.2024.

A PERFECT CROSS-CHECK BETWEEN THE TWO ORDERS

The Board took this decision on 11.11.2025 and it was conveyed on 22.12.2025 with effect from 01.04.2026. When the revised CWFGDS was notified on 11.02.2026, it carried the same decision into the GDS scheme in its own words — Para 14.1(6) reads “₹22,000 up to 31.03.2026; ₹30,000 w.e.f. 01.04.2026”.

The two orders therefore corroborate each other exactly. If an examiner offers ₹22,000 as an option, the correct response is that it was the rate up to 31.03.2026 and is no longer current.

Note also that the departmental rate (₹15,000) remains HALF the GDS rate (₹30,000) even after the revision — one of the standing exceptions to the general pattern.

(a) Accident of a GDS on duty requiring hospitalisation

Where a GDS meets with an accident while on duty and the accident requires hospitalisation for **more than three days**, financial assistance of **₹ 5,500** is payable. — Para 14.1(7) of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026. The three-day condition is a threshold: hospitalisation of exactly three days does not qualify.

(b) Nutritional assistance for tuberculosis — ○ unrevised

Assistance towards a nutritional diet is available to an employee or GDS suffering from tuberculosis, and in the case of departmental employees also to family members. The rate depends on whether the patient is receiving indoor (in-patient) or outdoor (out-patient) treatment. This head was not touched by the revision of 22.12.2025.

Category of patient	Indoor treatment	Outdoor treatment	Maximum period
Departmental employee and family	₹ 400 per month	₹ 200 per month	6 months
Gramin Dak Sevak	₹ 440 per month	₹ 220 per month	6 months

Table 3.5 — TB nutritional assistance. GDS rates verified at Para 14.1(8) of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026.

THE THREE CONDITIONS ATTACHED TO THE GDS TB GRANT

The CWFGDS attaches three cumulative conditions to the GDS grant, all of which are examinable:

1. It is admissible **ONLY ONCE**, and for a maximum period of six months.
2. The GDS must have put in at least **SIX YEARS** of service.
3. The treatment must be taken in a **GOVERNMENT HOSPITAL**.

(c) Assistance to a GDS suffering from COVID-19

A grant of **₹ 50,000** is payable to a GDS suffering from COVID-19, after consideration of the gravity of the case by the Head of the Circle. The head traces to Order No. 20-8/2020-WL & Sports dated 15.09.2021 and has been carried forward into Para 14.1(14) of the revised CWFGDS.

3.4 Assistance on EOL or HPL Due to Prolonged Illness — ○ Unrevised

An employee compelled by prolonged illness to proceed on Extraordinary Leave (EOL) or Half Pay Leave (HPL) suffers a sharp fall in income. The Circle Welfare Fund provides a monthly supplement. This head was not revised on 22.12.2025 and continues unchanged.

Nature of leave	Monthly assistance
Extraordinary Leave (EOL)	₹ 1,500 per month
Half Pay Leave (HPL)	₹ 750 per month

Table 3.6 — EOL / HPL assistance.

CONDITIONS — THE THREE NUMBERS TO REMEMBER

- The disease must be MORE THAN TWO MONTHS old.
- The assistance is given for a maximum period of THIRTY-SIX MONTHS.
- It is renewable at intervals of SIX MONTHS — it is not sanctioned in one stroke for the full 36 months.

3.5 Mobility Aids for Orthopaedically Handicapped Employees — ○ Unrevised

Three distinct benefits are available under this head from the Circle Welfare Fund, and candidates frequently confuse the ceilings. None of them was revised on 22.12.2025.

Benefit	Scale
Purchase of a mechanical or motorised tricycle by an orthopaedically handicapped departmental employee	₹ 15,000, or 50% of the cost of the tricycle, whichever is LESS
Purchase of an artificial limb, wheelchair or orthopaedic tricycle	75% of the cost, subject to a maximum of ₹ 2,000
Journey to an artificial-limb centre	Second-class railway fare from the place of duty to the artificial-limb centre and back, reimbursable from the Circle Welfare Fund

Table 3.7 — Mobility-aid assistance.

3.6 Specially Abled Children of Departmental Employees

The order of 22.12.2025 uses the expression “Specially Abled Children” in place of the older “handicapped children”, and revises the scholarship and both transport rates. It does NOT revise the hostel and mess subsidy, which therefore continues at its earlier rate.

Scheme	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Scholarship	₹ 500 per month	₹ 750 per month
Transport charges — ‘A’ Class city	₹ 300 per month	₹ 450 per month
Transport charges — another city	₹ 250 per month	₹ 375 per month
Hostel / mess subsidy — ‘A’ Class city	₹ 300 per month	Not revised — continues at ₹ 300 ○
Hostel / mess subsidy — another city	₹ 250 per month	Not revised — continues at ₹ 250 ○

Table 3.8 — Para III(d) of the order dated 22.12.2025, which traces the existing provisions to letter No. 1-19/97-WL & Sports dated 17.09.1997, letter No. 1-20/1997-WL & Sports dated 17.09.1997 and letter No. 1-01/2017-WL/Sports dated 31.01.2018.

THE ASYMMETRY WORTH NOTICING

Before the revision, transport charges and the hostel / mess subsidy were identical — ₹300 for an ‘A’ Class city and ₹250 for another city. The Board raised only the transport rates by 50%, and left the hostel subsidy alone.

So the correct current position is transport ₹450 / ₹375, but hostel and mess subsidy still ₹300 / ₹250. Answering ₹450 for the hostel subsidy is now a wrong answer, and it is a very easy one to slip into.

General conditions — ○ unrevised

- The scholarship is admissible for a maximum period of EIGHT YEARS.
- It cannot be drawn more than TWICE for the same class — a child repeating a class once may still be assisted, but not beyond that.
- The disability must be at least 40%. However, in the case of children who are totally blind, or deaf and dumb, NO such percentage limit applies.
- The benefit runs for classes 1 to 12, and the employee’s basic pay must not exceed ₹ 77,900.
- For the child of a GDS the corresponding scholarship is ₹ 220 per month, verified at Para 14.1(11) of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026, again for a maximum of eight years.

3.7 Financial Assistance Under the Education Scheme

This is the general education scholarship for the children of departmental employees. It was completely restructured on 22.12.2025, and the restructuring is the most consequential change in the whole order, because one of the five slabs changed not merely in amount but in character.

Stream / Degree / Diploma course	Existing provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
IIT, AIIMS and IIM	₹ 1,000 per month	₹ 1,500 per month
Medical / Technical Education / PG – DEGREE	₹ 800 per month	₹ 1,200 per month
Medical / Technical Education / PG – DIPLOMA	₹ 300 per month	₹ 450 per month
Non-Technical Degree – BA / B.Sc. / B.Com / Degree in Fine Arts	Girl students undergoing graduation in any field with a minimum of 60% aggregate marks in Class 12 — ₹ 250 per month	Girl students undergoing graduation in any field, IRRESPECTIVE OF MINIMUM PERCENTAGE — ₹ 375 per month
ITI Certificate Courses	₹ 1,400 per annum	₹ 2,100 per annum

Table 3.9 — against Para III(b) of the order dated 22.12.2025, which traces the existing provisions to letter No. 13-1/93-WL & Sports dated 20.05.1993, letter No. 1-01/2009-WL/Sports (Vol-II) dated 19.03.2013 and letter No. 1-01/2017-WL/Sports dated 31.01.2018.

THE OVERLAP RULE — NEW IN THE 2025 ORDER

The revised provision adds a tie-breaker in express terms: if any girl is eligible for multiple scholarships, the HIGHER will be paid.

The rule matters because a girl studying, say, B.Sc. Nursing could arguably fall both within the Medical / Technical Degree slab at ₹1,200 per month and within the non-technical girl-student slab at ₹375 per month. She receives ₹1,200 — not both, and not the lower.

Conditions governing the education scholarship

1. The requirement of securing at least 50% marks in the annual or semester examination for RENEWAL of technical scholarships shall continue, and scholars or students must not receive similar assistance from any other source.
2. Scholarships will be granted only for the CURRENT ACADEMIC YEAR. Students who have qualified their college or university examinations are required to submit a certificate duly endorsed by the Head of the Institution.
3. SEPARATE APPLICATIONS must be submitted for each ward, and fresh or first-time applicants must attach their Class 12 (or equivalent) mark sheet.

The order also attaches, at **Annexure-A**, an exhaustive list of the technical degree and diploma courses that qualify. That list is reproduced in condensed form below, because a question on whether a named course qualifies is easy to set and easy to lose.

Annexure-A — qualifying DEGREE courses

IIT courses; B.E. / B.Tech / B.Sc. (Engg.) in Civil, Mechanical, Electrical, Electronics, Metallurgical, Textile, Chemical, Computer Science, Instrumentation, Industrial Electronics, Sugar Technology, Plastic Technology, Printing Technology, Dairy Technology, Agricultural Engineering, Industrial Engineering, Production Engineering, Fisheries Technology, Marine Engineering, Engineering Design and Food Processing Technology; B.Sc. Degree (Agriculture); B.Arch.; M.B.B.S.; B.V.Sc.; B.D.S.; B.Pharmacy; Bachelor of Homeopathic Medicine (BHMS); B.Sc. Nursing; B.A.M.S.; B.F.Sc.; Management (after Class 12); I.I.M. (Bangalore, Ahmedabad); all other degree courses in Engineering or Technology recognised by the Director of Technical Education, UGC, Universities or AICTE; C.A.; M.B.A.; M.Sc. (Computer Science); MCA; Law; and Architecture.

Annexure-A — qualifying DIPLOMA courses (after Class 10)

All engineering subjects as listed for the degree courses; Diploma in Homeopathy and Ayurvedic courses; Diploma in Architecture; Diploma courses in Draughtsmanship; Hotel Management and Catering; Assistant Architect-ship; Diploma in Commercial Practice; Diploma in Pharmacy; Diploma in Prosthetics and Orthotics; Model Diploma Course for Technician; Diploma in Textile Designing; Diploma in Printing Technology; Interior Designing and Decorating; Industrial Safety; DHMS (4 years); Radio Engineering; Diploma in Post Harvest and Food Technology; Diploma in Coating Technology; Diploma in Cinema or Cinematography, Sound Recording or Sound Engineering; Diploma in Surface Coating; Indian Dairy Diploma courses; Knitting Technology; and all other diploma courses in polytechnics recognised by the Central or State Government.

The corresponding GDS rates

The GDS scholarship rates under the same head were not disturbed by the 2025 order and stand as set out in Para 14.1(9) of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026. Placed alongside the departmental rates, the contrast is stark:

Course	GDS	Departmental Employee
IIT / AIIMS / IIM	₹ 1,100 per month	₹ 1,500 per month
Technical education — Degree	₹ 308 per month	₹ 1,200 per month
Technical education — Diploma	₹ 209 per month	₹ 450 per month
Non-technical degree — BA / B.Sc. / B.Com / Fine Arts	₹ 165 per month	₹ 375 per month (girl students only)
ITI certificate course	₹ 1,034 per annum	₹ 2,100 per annum

Table 3.10 — Education scholarships, both streams. Note that the ITI slab is expressed PER ANNUM in both columns while every other slab is per month.

THE EARMARKED ALLOCATION — A NEW NUMBER

The order carries a note to Para III(c): the earmarked allocation for scholarships and educational assistance MAY BE REVISED FROM 55% TO 60%, IF NECESSARY.

This is the ceiling on the proportion of the welfare fund that may be devoted to scholarships and educational assistance. It is a new figure in circulation and has not appeared in any earlier compilation of these notes.

3.8 Incentive for Excellence in Academic Achievement — Classes 10 and 12

Five awards are admissible for the children of departmental employees. The amounts were raised by exactly 50% across all five positions with effect from 01.04.2026.

Sl.	Minimum aggregate in Class 10 and 12	Position	Old	New
1	90%	1st	₹ 6,000	₹ 9,000
2	90%	2nd	₹ 4,800	₹ 7,200
3	90%	3rd	₹ 4,200	₹ 6,300
4	90%	4th	₹ 3,600	₹ 5,400
5	90%	5th	₹ 3,000	₹ 4,500

Table 3.11 — against Para III(a) of the order dated 22.12.2025, which traces the existing provisions to letter No. 15016-1/86-WL & Sports dated 30.07.1990 and letter No. 1-01/2017-WL & Sports dated 31.01.2018.

THE NOTE TO PARA III(a) — READ IT WORD FOR WORD

The incentive is to be awarded to the FIRST FIVE HIGHEST PERCENTAGE children from the applications received, subject to the condition that the student must secure a minimum of 90% marks IN ALL THE SUBJECTS.

That last phrase is a genuine tightening. It is not enough for the aggregate to reach 90% — the child must have 90% in every subject.

However, a Circle where any prize for any position could not be awarded due to non-availability of eligible children with a minimum of 90% marks MAY ASK FOR APPLICATIONS UP TO 80%, in order to facilitate children in the top five positions.

The remaining terms and conditions remain unchanged — which is what preserves the four-group structure (Class 10, and Class 12 in Science, Commerce and Humanities) laid down by the order of 31.01.2018, and the requirement that the award be finalised and announced before 30th September each year.

Memory aid for the amounts: the revised figures are simply the existing figures plus half — 6000→9000, 4800→7200, 4200→6300, 3600→5400, 3000→4500.

The corresponding GDS incentive

Position in the Circle / Region	Departmental Employee's child	GDS's child
1st position	₹ 9,000	₹ 1,100
2nd position	₹ 7,200	₹ 880
3rd position	₹ 6,300	₹ 770
4th position	₹ 5,400	₹ 660
5th position	₹ 4,500	₹ 550

Table 3.12 — GDS column verified at Para 14.1(10) of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026. Memory aid for the GDS amounts: 1100 – 880 – 770 – 660 – 550.

○ The qualifying percentages for the children of GDS — 85% for Class 10 and Class 12 Science, and 80% for Class 12 Commerce and Arts — were not restated in either of the two governing orders and are carried forward from the earlier scheme. They should be treated as unrevised rather than as freshly verified.

3.9 Scholarship for the UPSC Examination — ○ Unrevised

A modest scholarship is payable to the child of a departmental employee preparing for the Civil Services Examination conducted by the UPSC. This head was not touched by the revision of 22.12.2025.

- Amount of financial assistance: ₹ 2,000.
- There is NO pay limit for the grant of this assistance — an unusual feature, since almost every other education benefit carries a basic-pay ceiling.
- It is provided ONCE to each child, after clearing the preliminary examination or after achieving the minimum qualifying marks of 60%.

3.10 Scholarship to SC / ST / OBC Employees

The order of 22.12.2025 revised this scheme and, in doing so, made a change of substance that has nothing to do with money: the heading now reads **“Scholarship to SC/ST/OBC employees for Deptt. Exam and Higher Education”**. OBC employees have been brought within the scheme. Every earlier compilation describes it as an SC/ST scheme only.

The order also states expressly what the money is for: the scholarship will cover a specified amount of tuition fees, books or other related expenses, AS A ONE-TIME GRANT.

Scheme / Examination	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
IPO / IRM / AAO examination	₹ 1,800	₹ 2,700
Jr. Accountant / UDC etc.	₹ 1,200	₹ 1,800

Scheme / Examination	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
PA, SA, Sorter etc.	₹ 900	₹ 1,350
Higher study — Class 10 to Class 12	₹ 1,200	₹ 1,800
Degree / Diploma or P.G. Degree	₹ 3,000	₹ 4,500

Table 3.13 — against Para III(c) of the order dated 22.12.2025, which traces the existing provisions to letter No. 24-46/90-WL/Sports dated 10.04.1991 and letter No. 1-01/2017-WL & Sports.

A CORRECTION TO THE EARLIER EDITIONS

Earlier editions described the higher-education component as “₹4,500 per annum, restricted to the fee paid”. The order describes the whole scheme as a ONE-TIME GRANT covering tuition fees, books or other related expenses. It is not an annual recurring payment.

Earlier editions also treated the scheme as available to SC and ST employees only. OBC employees are now covered.

The 60% marks condition for the Class 10 to Class 12 slab was not restated in the order and survives under Para VII as an unrevised condition.

3.11 Scholarship for Development of Individual Personality — ○ Unrevised

This scheme assists an employee who wishes to acquire a professional qualification in a listed discipline that improves his or her effectiveness in service. It was not revised on 22.12.2025.

Element	Provision
Quantum	75% of the fee paid by the employee, subject to a maximum of ₹ 2,000 per annum
Duration	Admissible for a maximum period of 2 years, and only ONCE during the entire service
Age condition	Employee must be below 35 years of age
Pay condition	Basic pay up to ₹ 44,900
Eligible disciplines	Personnel and Labour Management; Public Relations; Sociology; Social Work; Sports (NIS); Welfare Accounting; Computer Programming; Industrial Relations; and Banking

Table 3.14 — Personality development scholarship.

3.12 Grants to Welfare Organisations and Institutions

These schemes are institutional rather than individual — grants-in-aid to bodies that serve the postal community. All are subject to the general condition that the recipient organisation submits audited accounts for the previous year showing full utilisation of the grant already given. Of the group, only the grant to Residents' Welfare Associations was revised on 22.12.2025.

(a) Central Postal Ladies Organisation (CPLO) — ○ unrevised

Organisation	Annual grant
Central Organisation — at the Postal Directorate, Delhi	₹ 35,000 per annum
Circle Organisation — at the concerned Circle headquarters	₹ 25,000 per annum

Table 3.15 — CPLO grants. The President, CPLO is on the circulation list of the order of 22.12.2025, but no revision of the CPLO grant was made.

(b) Recreation Clubs — ○ unrevised

- Basic grant-in-aid: ₹ 25 per head per annum.
- In addition, a further grant-in-aid of up to ₹ 25 per head per annum, to MATCH the subscription actually collected by the club during the financial year.
- Maximum grant to any one club: ₹ 25,000.

(c) Residents' Welfare Associations — revised, with new conditions

Scheme	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Financial assistance to an RWA for organising various welfare activities and maintenance	₹ 30 per residential quarter per annum	₹ 45 per residential quarter per annum

Table 3.16 — against Para IV of the order dated 22.12.2025, which traces the existing provision to letter No. 1-3/99-WL/Sport dated 01.06.2000 and letter No. 1-01/2017-WL/Sports dated 31.01.2018.

The order also attaches, at **Annexure-B**, a fresh set of ten conditions approved by the Board for the governance of Residents' Welfare Associations. These are entirely new material and have not appeared in any earlier edition of these notes. They are set out below, because they are exactly the kind of provision from which a Paper I question is built.

Annexure-B — the ten conditions governing RWAs

4. There should be a minimum of 200 members in the association. The limit of 200 may be relaxed on a case-to-case basis by the Circle or Regional Office, taking into account the bifurcation of residents and accounts between Postal and BSNL / MTNL.

5. Two posts of the Managing Committee or Governing Council shall PREFERABLY be filled with WOMEN members of the RWA. If no nomination is received from women, the post may be filled with a male member.
6. The sources of income of the RWA shall be: (i) subscription and fees as laid down in the constitution, and funds raised from time to time on specified counts; (ii) grants-in-aid from the Circle or Regional Office; and (iii) donations from Government(s) or official bodies.
7. Chowkidar funds, if any, collected by RWAs are SEPARATE from the above income, and expenditure from that fund shall be audited and presented in the General Body Meeting, at which the Welfare Officer shall be present.
8. All the work of the RWA will be controlled by the concerned DIVISIONAL HEAD, except the financial assistance provided to the RWA by the Circle Office or Regional Office.
9. The Governing Body or Council has the right to accept or reject resignations of office bearers and members, and to fill the resulting vacancies — office-bearer vacancies from amongst the elected members of the Governing Body, and Managing Committee vacancies from amongst the “regular” members of the association. Vacancies may be filled for the remaining part of the term, subject to the condition that the total vacancies to be filled do not exceed or constitute two-thirds of the total posts of the Governing Body during the block year. A report on the filling up of vacancies shall be sent to the Divisional Office and must be presented for ratification at the next General Body meeting, which should be held within two months; the decision of the General Body shall be intimated to the concerned Divisional Office. Any office-bearer or member of the Governing Body directly or indirectly involved in political activity may be removed from the Governing Body, and the concerned Divisional Office may take suitable disciplinary action under the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964.
10. A new Governing Body should be elected after the completion of the term of the previous Governing Body, to maintain transparency.
11. Withdrawals from the bank shall be authorised by the JOINT SIGNATURES of the Treasurer and either the President or the Secretary. The outgoing Governing Body shall not make any withdrawal from the bank account after the date of election.
12. The Governing Body of the RWA shall refrain from affiliating or federating with any external association, given that its membership is comprised of postal employees.
13. The main duties of the RWA, the responsibilities of the Divisional Office and Circle Office, the Postal RWA Guidelines, and the powers and duties of the members of the Governing Council would remain the same.

THE POINTS MOST LIKELY TO BE ASKED FROM ANNEXURE-B

- 200 — minimum membership, relaxable case-to-case by the Circle or Regional Office, having regard to the Postal / BSNL / MTNL bifurcation.
- Two — posts on the Managing Committee preferably filled by women.
- Two-thirds — the outer limit on vacancies that may be filled by the Governing Body during a block year.
- Two months — the period within which the General Body meeting must be held to ratify vacancy filling.
- Joint signatures — Treasurer plus President or Secretary, for any bank withdrawal.
- Political activity by an office-bearer attracts removal from the Governing Body and disciplinary action under the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 — note the year 1964, not 1965.
- Control of the RWA vests in the DIVISIONAL HEAD, except for the financial assistance, which is the Circle or Regional Office's business.

(d) Crèches — ○ unrevised

Element	Provision
Age of child for admission	6 months to 10 years
Children per employee	Maximum 2 children of an employee
Size of the crèche	Minimum 1 child and maximum 25 children
Working pattern	26 days in a month, and 8 hours per day
Non-recurring grant for starting a crèche	₹ 60,000
Non-recurring expenditure thereafter	₹ 20,000 at the end of every 3 years
Recurring grant	₹ 1,500 per month per child, subject to a maximum of ₹ 38,000
Staffing — up to 10 children	1 crèche worker and 1 crèche helper
Staffing — more than 10 and up to 25 children	1 crèche worker and 2 crèche helpers

Table 3.17 — Crèche scheme. Note that the number of WORKERS stays at one throughout; only the number of HELPERS increases.

(e) Excursion trips — revised

Scheme provision	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Radius (in kilometres)	700 km, once in a year	1,000 km (ONE-SIDED) once a year; OR 200 km (ONE-SIDED) TWICE in a year

Scheme provision	Old provision	Revised provision w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Subsidy on travel cost (up to basic pay ₹ 65,200)	60%	75%

Table 3.18 — against Para V of the order dated 22.12.2025, which traces the existing provisions to letter No. 19-2/90-WL & Sports dated 11.07.1990, letter No. 1-19/97-WL/Sp dated 01.06.2000 and letter No. 1-01/2009-WL/Sports (Vol-II) dated 19.03.2013.

A CORRECTION TO THE EARLIER EDITIONS

Earlier editions described the alternative as “200 km both sides once a year”. The order reads “200 Kms (one-sided) TWICE in a Year”. The distance is measured one-sided in both limbs of the option; what changes between them is the frequency — once a year for the long trip, twice a year for the short one.

Earlier editions also gave the subsidy as 75% without noting that it was raised from 60%. Both figures are now examinable.

The “4 to 5 days” duration, the requirement of the Head of Circle’s approval, and the ceiling of two officially sponsored trips in a financial year were not restated in the order and survive as unrevised conditions under Para VII.

(f) Tailoring classes — ○ unrevised

- One-time non-recurring grant for starting the class: ₹ 5,000.
- Honorarium to the tailoring teacher: ₹ 750 per month.

3.13 Holiday Homes

The Board described this item as “enhancing policy and structural reforms in holiday homes”. Two sets of figures were revised: the rent recovered from the occupant, and the ceilings on furnishing and maintaining the premises.

(a) Rent — for ONE SUITE only

Pay scale of the occupant	Old rate	Revised rate w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Basic pay ₹ 35,400 (7th CPC)	₹ 40 per day	₹ 60 per day
Exceeding basic pay ₹ 35,400 (7th CPC)	₹ 100 per day	₹ 150 per day

Table 3.19 — against Para VI(a) of the order dated 22.12.2025. The order is explicit that the revised rent is for ONE SUITE ONLY — a qualification that did not appear in earlier compilations.

(b) Up-keep and management of suites and common rooms

This is a revision of sub-paragraphs (vii), (viii) and (ix) of paragraph III of the Guidelines for Holiday Homes issued vide letter No. 1-1/2017-WL/Sports dated 12.03.2019.

Item of expenditure	Old ceiling	Revised ceiling w.e.f. 01.04.2026
Total cost of furniture and essential equipment for the COMMON ROOM	₹ 70,000	₹ 1,00,000
Total cost of furniture, utensils, crockery etc. for EACH SUITE	₹ 50,000	₹ 75,000
Total cost of petty replacements such as electricity and water	₹ 5,000	₹ 7,500

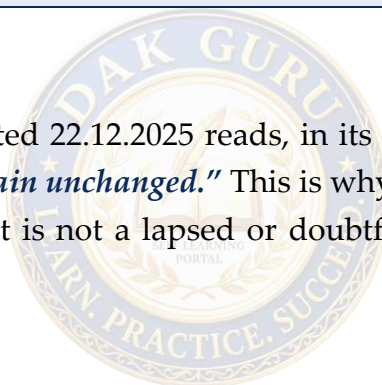
Table 3.20 — against Para VI(b) of the order dated 22.12.2025.

SUPPORTING RULE ON HIRING — ○ unrevised

Heads of Circles have been delegated the same financial power for hiring accommodation for holiday homes as is available for hiring office-cum-residence accommodation, subject to the same terms and conditions. The rent must be approved by the Fair Rent Assessment Committee of the Circle, and all the formalities and rules applicable to hiring office-cum-residence accommodation must be observed.

3.14 The Closing Provision

Paragraph VII of the order dated 22.12.2025 reads, in its entirety: *“All the other existing terms and conditions will remain unchanged.”* This is why every scheme marked ○ in this Part remains fully operative. It is not a lapsed or doubtful rate — it is a rate the Board deliberately left alone.



PART 4 – CIRCLE WELFARE FUND FOR GRAMIN DAK SEVAKS (CWFGDS)

THE GOVERNING ORDER – LEARN THIS CITATION

O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports, Government of India, Ministry of Communications, Department of Posts, Welfare & Sports Section, Dak Bhawan, Sansad Marg, New Delhi – 110001, dated 11.02.2026, signed by (Sunita), Director (Welfare & Sports), and circulated by (Ankit Panwar), Section Officer (Welfare and Sports Section).

Issued with the concurrence of the JS & FA (diary No. 232/2025-26/FA-CS(P) dated 10.02.2026) and the administrative approval of the Director General (Postal Services).

It SUPERSEDES O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.09.2024. Further, Para 17 of Annexure-B provides that this scheme SUPERSEDES ALL PREVIOUS ORDERS about GDS issued, if any, which stand automatically discontinued with the issue of this O.M.

The order runs to nineteen operative paragraphs plus nine annexures: Annexure-A (bye-laws), Annexure-B (guidelines, terms and conditions), and Annexures C to I (Forms I to VII). Everything in this Part is against that text.

4.1 Name, Control and Decentralisation

- The scheme is known as the Circle Welfare Fund for Gramin Dak Sevaks (CWFGDS). In the bye-laws it is also referred to as “the Scheme”, “the Fund” or “GDSCWF”.
- The CWFGDS is controlled by the Chief Postmaster General.
- To decentralise implementation and ensure fast decision-making, powers in respect of the GDS Fund are delegated at the Regional level to the Regional PMGs.

The structural arrangement is subtle and regularly examined. There is **only ONE single Circle Fund**. The Regional Funds are not separate funds; they are the proportionate amount pertaining to each Region, operated at the Regional level by the Regional PMG **under the overall control of the Head of the Circle**.

Every Regional PMG is to be intimated, **as on 1st April of every year**, of the amount of fund available for operation for Regional implementation — and that intimation follows an audit of the disbursements, payments received and payments made from the fund, carried out by an **Accounts Officer of the Circle nominated by the CPMG**. Para 1.3.

4.2 Objective and the Statistics in the Order

The order records that as on **31.03.2024** there were **2,67,836 Gramin Dak Sevaks** managing the rural postal network of **1,39,891 Branch Post Offices** in the country. The Fund is to be utilised exclusively for the welfare of Gramin Dak Sevaks, and is managed and operated at the Circle level by the respective Heads of Circles. Para 2.

The bye-laws state the objective more plainly: to provide financial assistance to Gramin Dak Sevaks in their need of the hour. They add that the Scheme will be subject to review

by the DG Posts for revising the amount and scope, to cover more kinds of assistance as the situation may demand. Annexure-A, clause 2.

4.3 Scope, Membership and Cessation

(a) Who is covered

- The scheme is MANDATORY and applies to all REGULARLY ENGAGED and serving Gramin Dak Sevaks working in the Postal Circles.
- It does NOT cover a substitute working in place of a GDS on a leave arrangement.
- It does NOT cover a provisionally engaged GDS.
- A GDS who is a member and who is placed UNDER PUT OFF DUTY may continue the membership by paying the subscription regularly for the period. Annexure-A, clause 3.3.

(b) How long membership lasts

Membership is valid so long as the subscription is paid, and **ceases when the GDS reaches the maximum age of service, i.e. 65 years.** Annexure-A, clause 3.4.

Situation	Consequence
Non-recovery of subscription due to ADMINISTRATIVE reasons	Recovered in subsequent months WITHOUT any interest
Non-recovery due to any reason ATTRIBUTABLE TO THE GDS	Recovered in subsequent months WITH penal interest of ₹ 1 per month, per instalment of subscription
Subscription not recovered continuously for SIX months without valid reason	Membership stands TERMINATED and no benefits are payable under the Scheme

Table 4.1 — Annexure-A, clause 3.4. The ₹1 per month penal interest is a small figure that is very easy to set a question on.

(c) When a GDS ceases to be covered and forfeits all entitlement

A Gramin Dak Sevak ceases to be covered by the Scheme, and in consequence forfeits all entitlement to any benefit provided by it, when he or she —

14. Is discharged on attaining the age of 65 years, or is discharged from service by the competent authority before the prescribed age of discharge, or on invalidation on medical grounds; OR
15. Is removed or dismissed from service by any authority competent to order such removal or dismissal, or his services are terminated; OR
16. Resigns from service; OR
17. Is reported a defaulter due to any reason whatsoever.

THE ONE-YEAR PROTECTION FOR POST REDUCTION – CLAUSE 3.6

Those GDS who are discharged from their post DUE TO REDUCTION OF POST(S) continue to be entitled to the benefit of relief from the Scheme up to a maximum of ONE YEAR after the date of their discharge – provided they continue as members by paying the contribution regularly for the period.

This is a genuinely distinct provision and is easily confused with the ordinary cessation rules above. Discharge on abolition of the post is treated more kindly than discharge for any other reason.

4.4 Definitions Under the Bye-Laws

Term	Definition in Annexure-A, clause 4
Subscription	The prescribed amount as determined from time to time, payable by a GDS as a member, for enrolment or continuance as a member
Committee	The Managing Committee constituted under clause 10 of the Bye-Laws
Members	All eligible GDS in the concerned Postal Circle paying subscriptions as provided under clause 8
Fund	The total sum of subscriptions paid by members, together with interest on balances and investments and any grant received for the purpose of the Scheme. It also includes any amount collected by means of donations, sale of tickets for benefit shows, and advertisement charges realised by issue of a souvenir
GDSBPMs	Wherever the term GDSBPMs is used it will ALSO INCLUDE GDSSPMs
Accident	An incident due to which hurt or injury is caused to the body, which may cause death
Final deciding authority	The CPMG, in the case of GDS working in the area directly under the control of the CPMG, as well as in all matters regarding GDS in the Regions referred to him by Regional PMGs

Table 4.2 – The defined terms. The definition of “Accident” is short enough to be quoted verbatim in an examination and is worth memorising.

4.5 Subscription and Finance of the Fund

Element	Provision
Rate of subscription	Uniform rate of ₹ 40 per month for every Gramin Dak Sevak
Annual subscription	₹ 480, recovered in ONE LUMP SUM in the month of April, from the TRCA of March, every year – so as to minimise accounting work
Newly engaged GDS	Recovered from the first month’s TRCA on a proportionate basis at ₹ 40 per month for all the months up to the end of the financial year, irrespective of the date in the month on which the GDS joins

Element	Provision
Uniformity	The subscription is the SAME for all members irrespective of the category of the GDS
Refund	NO refund of any amount subscribed to the Fund is allowed for any reason whatsoever. However, an amount credited to the Fund due to WRONG RECOVERY or BY MISTAKE may be refunded
Additional finance	The Managing Committee may raise additional finance by raising donations, sale of tickets of benefit shows, issue of a souvenir with paid advertisements, or by any other means approved by the Head of the Circle for the purpose

Table 4.3 — Paras 5 and 11.2 of the order, read with Annexure-A clauses 6 and 8.

WHAT CHANGED HERE — AND WHAT DID NOT

The rate of ₹40 per month is NOT new. It was already ₹40 under the scheme that came into force on 01.07.2024, which had itself doubled the earlier rate of ₹20 per month.

What HAS gone is the transitional arithmetic of the changeover year. Under the 2024 scheme the recovery for 2024-25 was split — ₹20 per month for April to June 2024 and ₹40 per month from July 2024 to March 2025. That split was a one-time feature and has no application now. Earlier editions of these notes carried it as though it were a live rule; it has been removed.

Likewise the transitional grant-in-aid of ₹175 per GDS for 2024-25 (₹25 for April–June plus ₹150 for July 2024–March 2025) is spent history. The rate is now a flat ₹200 per GDS per year.

4.6 Commencement

The scheme comes into force **with effect from the date of issue** — that is, 11.02.2026 — and is made mandatory for all Gramin Dak Sevaks staff. Subscription continues to be regulated as per Para 5. **The date 01.07.2024, which was the commencement date of the superseded scheme, is no longer the correct answer.** Para 6, read with Annexure-A clause 5.

4.7 Recovery of Subscription from Members

18. The annual subscription is recovered from all eligible Gramin Dak Sevaks by the Accounts Branch of the Head Post Office.
19. The Head Post Office remits the collections to the Treasurer of the Managing Committee, along with the list of members, category-wise, under intimation to the SSP / SP / SSRM / SRM etc.
20. A similar procedure is adopted mutatis mutandis in the case of the SRO / HRO of RMS.
21. The Accounts Branch of the Head Post Office maintains the register of GDS and ensures recovery every year in the month of April, in one lump sum.

For a GDS engaged at any time during the year, the pro-rata subscription is deducted from the TRCA from the month of joining to the financial year end. Para 7, read with Annexure-A clause 7.

4.8 Nomination

The bye-laws devote a full clause to nomination, and it is a rich source of examination questions because the rules turn on whether the member has a family.

22. The nominations furnished by the GDS AT THE TIME OF ENGAGEMENT are the valid nominations for the purpose of this Scheme, unless a revised option is exercised consequent on the nominee pre-deceasing.
23. If a member HAS a family, the nomination shall be only in favour of a member of his or her family. A nomination made in favour of a person other than a family member, when he or she has a family, is DEEMED TO BE INVALID.
24. If a member has NO family, he or she may nominate any person to receive the relief. However, if he or she ACQUIRES a family later on, the nomination given earlier automatically ceases to be valid, and the member must furnish a fresh nomination.
25. "Family" for the purpose of this Scheme is as defined in the Department of Posts Gramin Dak Sevak (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020.
26. In the event of the death of a member, if there is NO nomination and the family members do not express consent unanimously in favour of the claimant, the PRESIDENT of the Managing Committee may sanction the amount in favour of ALL the family members in EQUAL SHARES.
27. If the nominee is a MINOR, the relief is paid to the surviving parent, provided the minor is in his or her care and custody. If the minor nominee has no surviving parent, or is not in the care and custody of the surviving parent, the relief may be made to the DE-FACTO GUARDIAN having the care and custody of the minor, on production of a guardianship certificate.

Annexure-A, clause 9.

4.9 Application and the Decision Cycle

(a) How an application is made

- For JOINING the Fund, the GDS fills in Form-I (Annexure-C). The Divisional Head obtains this from each GDS along with a requisition letter and a declaration that he has gone through the Bye-Laws and the terms and conditions and accepts the same.
- For FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE, the application is submitted in Form-II (Annexure-D), certified and recommended by the Controlling Authority.
- In a death case, the Controlling Authority and Divisional Head must report the fact of death AT THE EARLIEST, with an application and an attested copy of the death

certificate, to the Secretary of the Managing Committee, duly certifying the fact of regular contribution paid by the deceased.

- In accidental death, the additional details in the prescribed forms must be obtained and forwarded. In a major surgical operation, the forms and details must be forwarded duly supported by evidence of the operation and certificates.

(b) The priority rule

Applications are decided on a **first-come, first-served** basis. The date taken into account is the **date of application of the GDS**. The order expressly states that applicants cannot be held responsible for administrative delay in forwarding their case to the Divisional Office; therefore, in the Circle or Regional Office, the date of submission of the application by the GDS to his Controlling Officer is the date taken for priority. Para 8.2.

(c) Scrutiny

- The Divisional Head cross-checks the eligibility criteria BEFORE recommending, and forwards the application with a clear remark — “Recommended” or “Not recommended” — with a brief justification.
- In the Regional Office / Circle Office all applications are scrutinised once again, and those fulfilling all criteria are retained for submission before the competent Committee.
- The Committee must comprise a MINIMUM OF THREE OFFICERS from the Regional Office or Circle Office.
- Non-eligible applications are returned to the Divisional Heads with the ground or reason recorded.

(d) The quarterly meeting cycle

Applications received during	Decided in the meeting held in
January to March	April
April to June	July
July to September	October
October to December	January

Table 4.4 — Para 8.4. Formal minutes are issued and circulated to all Divisional Heads.

THE THREE EXCEPTIONS TO THE QUARTERLY CYCLE

The general rule at Annexure-B is that all cases of financial assistance EXCEPT DEATH CASES are decided on a quarterly basis. Three departures are expressly provided for:

1. For Sl. Nos. 1 and 5 of Para 14.1 — that is, immediate death relief of ₹11,000 AND funeral expenses of ₹5,500 — the assistance may be released IMMEDIATELY by the Divisional Heads, and thereafter sanctioned by the CPMG / PMG without waiting for the quarterly meeting.

2. For floods and natural calamities, the concerned Management Committee may conduct a SPECIAL MEETING to decide the assistance, without waiting for the quarterly meeting.

3. In the case of payment of funeral expenses, the payment may be ordered by the LOCAL CONTROLLING AUTHORITY, pending ex-post-facto sanction by the competent authority (Para 17 of the main order).

Cases under Sl. Nos. 2, 3 and 4 — the three high-value death heads — go to the Regional or Circle level committee in the ordinary way.

4.10 Administering the Scheme and the Managing Committees

- The CWFGDS is managed by the Managing Committee constituted under clause 10 of the bye-laws.
- The HEAD OF REGION is the final authority in deciding cases of financial grants to GDS in the Region.
- The HEAD OF CIRCLE is the coordinating and final authority in resolving all matters relating to the scheme, grants and assistance in the Circle. The decision of the Head of Circle in all matters regarding grants to eligible GDS is FINAL.
- The power to make any change in the SCOPE of the scheme lies ONLY with the Director General, Postal Services. All powers regarding amendment in any part of the Scheme, in the larger interest of members, likewise rest with the Director General Posts.
- At least TWO representatives of the Staff Union of GDS — or, where there are none, any two GDS having good knowledge of welfare schemes and rules and the ability to present the cases of other GDS — must be included as Members in the GDS Welfare Committee at Circle and Regional level while scrutinising and deciding cases.

(a) Circle-level Managing Committee

Post on the Committee	Officer
(i) President	Chief Postmaster General
(ii) Vice-President	Director Postal Services (Headquarters)
(iii) Secretary	Assistant Director incharge of Welfare & Sports in Circle Office
(iv) Treasurer	Accounts Officer in Circle Office
(v) Member-I	GDS Staff Union member from the Circle
(vi) Member-II	GDS Staff Union member from the Circle

(b) Region-level Managing Committee

Post on the Committee	Officer
(i) President	Postmaster General (Region)
(ii) Vice-President	Director Postal Services (Region)
(iii) Secretary	Assistant Director incharge of Welfare & Sports in Regional Office
(iv) Treasurer	Accounts Officer in Regional Office
(v) Member-I	NOMINATED GDS / GDS Staff Union member from the Region
(vi) Member-II	NOMINATED GDS / GDS Staff Union member from the Region

Tables 4.5 and 4.6 — Annexure-A, clauses 10.1 and 10.3. All the office bearers of both Committees are EX-OFFICIO members; therefore there is NO prescribed term for the Managing Committee (clauses 10.2 and 10.4).

THE ONE ASYMMETRY BETWEEN THE TWO COMMITTEES

The two committees are otherwise identical in structure. The single difference is in the two Member slots: at Circle level they read “GDS Staff Union member from the Circle”, while at Regional level they read “Nominated GDS / GDS Staff Union member from the Region”.

The Regional formulation is therefore wider — it accommodates a nominated GDS where no union representative is available, which is exactly what Para 9.3 of the main order contemplates.

(c) Duties of the office bearers

Office bearer	Duties under Annexure-A, clause 11
President	Head of the Managing Committee; presides over the meetings; decides disputed issues and cases related to the Scheme; accords the sanction of relief or grant for various items from the fund in accordance with the provisions, after satisfying himself that the claim is genuine and in order
Vice-President	Assists the President in all the work relating to this Scheme
Secretary	Ensures smooth and proper implementation; arranges the timely meetings of the Managing Committee and brings to its notice all matters requiring its consideration; conducts all correspondence on behalf of the Committee; receives and processes claims and representations; records or arranges to record the minutes. Operates the bank account TOGETHER WITH the Treasurer. After the President’s approval of a claim, issues the sanction for payment of the relief
Treasurer	Responsible to the Committee for the proper conduct of matters relating to the finances of the fund; accounts for money received and payments made; maintains receipts, payments, accounts and vouchers; supplies relevant information whenever required; promptly remits to the bank all money received; on receipt of sanctions arranges remittance of relief promptly;

Office bearer	Duties under Annexure-A, clause 11
	operates the account jointly with the Secretary; brings to the notice of the Secretary and the Committee all matters relating to the finance of the fund requiring attention, and particularly the irregularities coming to his or her notice

Table 4.7 — Duties of office bearers.

THE JOINT-SIGNATURE RULE

The Secretary and the Treasurer are JOINTLY authorised to sign cheques for payment of grant and to incur other expenditure in connection with the implementation of the Scheme. The bank account is operated by the Secretary together with the Treasurer.

So three different people appear in the payment chain and are commonly confused in questions: the PRESIDENT approves the claim, the SECRETARY issues the sanction for payment, and the SECRETARY AND TREASURER JOINTLY sign the cheque.

4.11 Eligibility

All Gramin Dak Sevaks are eligible for benefits, subject to the condition that they have been duly engaged by the competent authority in accordance with the laid-down procedure of the Department, and that the engagement orders of the GDS are available on record. Para 10.

4.12 Contributory Character and the Illustration in the Order

The scheme is contributory in nature, with a component of grant-in-aid from the Central Postal Welfare Fund of the Department. The order sets out a worked illustration which is ready-made examination material:

Illustration in Para 11.2	Working	Result
(a) Amount per month contributed by each GDS employee	—	₹ 40
(b) Yearly contribution	₹ 40 × 12	₹ 480
(c) In one Circle if there are 10,000 GDS	₹ 480 × 10,000	₹ 48,00,000
(d) GDS entering service at age 18 and retiring at 65, i.e. total 47 years, will contribute	₹ 480 × 47	₹ 22,560

Table 4.8 — Para 11.2.

AN INFERENCE HIDDEN IN THE ILLUSTRATION

The illustration assumes a GDS entering service at 18 and retiring at 65, giving 47 years of contribution. This is the order's own confirmation that the outer age of engagement for GDS is 65 — which the bye-laws state expressly at clause 3.4.

It also explains why the retirement-benefit table at Para 16 has ten slabs and ends with “more than 45 years”: a service span of up to 47 years has to be accommodated.

4.13 Grant-in-Aid from the Central Postal Welfare Fund

An amount of **₹ 200 per GDS per year** — on the basis of the actual number of working GDS — is granted from the Central Welfare Fund to each Circle, as a one-time annual contribution on a recurring basis. The order’s own example: if a Circle has 10,000 GDS working as on 31st March of a particular year, then ₹20,00,000 will be contributed by the Central Welfare Fund of the Directorate to that Circle for the financial year falling thereafter. Para 12.

4.14 The Three Components of the Scheme

Component	Nature	Governed by
(i) Financial Grant	Non-repayable assistance under 14 specified heads	Para 14
(ii) Financial assistance by way of LOAN	Repayable, at a lower rate of simple interest of 5% or 3% per annum	Para 15
(iii) One-time repayment at the time of retirement	Payable only to a GDS who has never availed of any financial assistance	Para 16

Table 4.9 — Para 13.

4.15 Component (i) — The Fourteen Heads of Financial Grant

This is the single most examinable table in the entire topic. It is reproduced below exactly as it stands in Para 14.1, with the head numbers preserved, because questions are sometimes framed by head number and because the utilisation ceilings in Annexure-B are expressed by reference to these same numbers.

No.	Head of financial grant	Amount
1	Financial assistance to the families of deceased GDS to meet immediate expenses following death, irrespective of whether the death occurs during duty or outside duty hours	₹ 11,000
2	Financial assistance in case of death due to terrorist or extremist activity WHILE ON DUTY	₹ 1,65,000
3	Financial assistance in case of death of GDS due to terrorist or extremist activity WHILE NOT ON DUTY	₹ 13,200
4	Financial assistance in case of death of GDS WHILE BEING ON DUTY due to accident	₹ 27,500
5	Funeral expenses on death of GDS — payable where the last rites are performed by brothers or sisters or near relatives in the absence of any other next of kin	₹ 5,500
6	Financial assistance in case of major surgical operations in ailments like cancer, brain haemorrhage, kidney failure or transplant, heart surgery etc.	₹ 22,000 up to 31.03.2026; ₹ 30,000 w.e.f. 01.04.2026
7	Financial assistance in case of accident of GDS while being on duty, requiring hospitalisation for MORE THAN THREE DAYS	₹ 5,500
8	Financial assistance for nutritional diet to GDS suffering from TB — only once, for a maximum period of six months, provided the GDS has put in at least six years of service and treatment is taken in a government hospital	Indoor – ₹ 440 p.m.; Outdoor – ₹ 220 p.m.
9	Grant of scholarship under educational schemes to the children of GDS (as per existing terms and conditions)	IIT/AIIMS/IIM – ₹ 1,100 p.m.; Degree – ₹ 308 p.m.; Diploma – ₹ 209 p.m.; Non-technical – ₹ 165 p.m.; ITI – ₹ 1,034 p.a.
10	Incentive for excellence in academic achievement for 10th and 12th class	1st – ₹ 1,100; 2nd – ₹ 880; 3rd – ₹ 770; 4th – ₹ 660; 5th – ₹ 550

No.	Head of financial grant	Amount
11	Scholarship for physically handicapped children of GDS — for a maximum of 8 years, on existing terms and conditions	₹ 220 per month
12	Maternity grant to woman GDS	DELETED
13	Financial assistance in cases of natural calamities like fire, floods etc.	₹ 5,500
14	Financial assistance to GDS suffering from COVID, after consideration of the gravity of the case by the Head of Circle	₹ 50,000

Table 4.10 — Para 14.1 of the O.M. dated 11.02.2026.

HEAD 12 — THE DELETED MATERNITY GRANT

The maternity grant to a woman GDS survives in the order only as a deleted entry, and the reason is given expressly: as per letter No. 15-1/2016-WL & Sp dated 29.08.2018, this assistance is overridden by O.M. No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 27.06.2018 issued by the Establishment Division.

The benefit did not disappear — it moved. Maternity provision for GDS is now dealt with under the engagement conditions rather than out of the welfare fund, and paying it twice from two sources is exactly what the deletion prevents.

This is the standing answer to “which of the following is NOT a head of financial grant under the CWFGDS”.

The once-only rule and its two exceptions

Para 14.3 provides that an individual is eligible **only once** for a financial grant under a particular head, and cannot apply more than one time for the same purpose for the same person. Annexure-B, however, creates an express relaxation: **this condition CAN BE WAIVED in the case of financial assistance for NATURAL CALAMITY and for MAJOR SURGICAL OPERATIONS**, by the concerned Management Committee, in really deserving cases.

Further, in case of any ambiguity in the terms, conditions or any other aspect of the scheme — particularly in respect of the financial grants listed under Para 14.1 — the action or decision is to be guided and governed by the various orders issued by the Directorate on that item or subject, including orders that may be issued in future.

4.16 The Detailed Conditions Governing the Financial Grants

Annexure-B lays down, head by head, the conditions on which each grant is admissible. These conditions are where most of the fine detail of this topic lives.

(a) Illness and surgery — heads 6 to 8

Element	Provision
Delegation to CPMsG / PMG	Powers to sanction financial assistance up to ₹ 30,000 in each case of PROVED EXCEPTIONAL HARDSHIP arising out of serious or prolonged illness or major surgical operations; and up to ₹ 5,500 in cases of accident while on duty requiring hospitalisation for more than three days
Nature of the assistance	It is for meeting the INCIDENTAL expenses like diet, cost of treatment, transport etc. It is expressly NOT to be mistaken for reimbursement of medical bills or expenditure
Basis of decision	Each case is to be decided ON MERIT
Beyond the ceiling	In rare and exceptionally deserving cases, where additional assistance beyond the above limits is considered necessary, the case may be referred to the Postal Directorate in Form-III (Annexure-E)

Table 4.11 — Annexure-B, para 4.

What must accompany a reference to the Directorate

- Personal recommendation of the concerned CPMsG / PMsG indicating the SPECIFIC AMOUNT of assistance recommended, submitted in Form-III (Annexure-E).
- Copies of the medical report and copies of the bills of expenditure towards treatment.
- Information regarding total expenditure on treatment, and grants already received from the Circle Welfare Fund.
- The financial position of the concerned GDS.

(b) Nutritional diet for tuberculosis — head 8

Element	Provision
Indoor patient	For the period the GDS remains HOSPITALISED, ₹ 440 per month for nutritive diet
Thereafter	On discharge from hospital, if he continues to take treatment as an outdoor patient, ₹ 220 per month
Outdoor from the start	If the GDS takes treatment as an outdoor patient, ₹ 220 per month for a maximum period of six months
Total period	The total period of financial assistance, INCLUDING BOTH indoor and outdoor treatment, is limited to a maximum of SIX MONTHS

Element	Provision
Service condition	The GDS must have put in at least SIX YEARS of service in the Department
Proof required	Medical certificate from a Medical Officer of a Government Hospital or TB sanatorium for having taken the treatment from there
Date from which paid	From the date of application, OR the date on which the disease becomes TWO MONTHS OLD, whichever is EARLIER
Time-limit for applying	The application should be received within THREE MONTHS of detection of the illness. No application is accepted thereafter unless valid justification for the delay is provided by the GDS
Whose treatment	The application is to be considered in the case of treatment of SELF ONLY

Table 4.12 — Annexure-B, para 4(iv). Contrast this with the departmental TB scheme, which covers the employee AND family; the GDS scheme is for self only.

(c) Educational scholarships — heads 9 to 11

Annexure-B fixes a different minimum-marks threshold for each slab, and — importantly — dispenses with the threshold entirely for the premier institutions.

Course	Rate	Minimum marks in the qualifying examination
IIT, AIIMS and IIM	₹ 1,100 per month	NO restriction of minimum marks whatsoever
Technical education — Degree	₹ 308 per month	85%
Technical education — Diploma	₹ 209 per month	85%
Non-Technical Degree — BA / B.Sc. / B.Com / Degree in Fine Arts	₹ 165 per month	80%
ITI Certificate Courses	₹ 1,034 per annum	65%

Table 4.13 — Annexure-B, para 5(I)(a). The order words the qualifying condition as “more than” the stated percentage.

Award, renewal and cessation of the GDS scholarship

28. The scholarship once awarded is admissible up to the maximum period of the prescribed duration of the course, and not for a period longer than that.
29. It is awarded for the FIRST YEAR of the course and thereafter is subject to continuation or renewal every year, on a year-to-year basis, by the Heads of Circle or Region.
30. For the first year, the scholarship is granted on submission of a copy of the admission certificate or enrolment number issued by the institute, a copy of the mark-sheet in the qualifying examination — NOT applicable in the case of admission to IIT, IIM or AIIMS — and the prescribed application form.

31. For renewal, authenticated photocopies of TWO certificates are required: (A) a photocopy of the mark sheet of the previous year's course; and (B) a photocopy of a certificate that the student is promoted to the next higher class or semester by the institution or university.
32. For renewal or continuation, a minimum of 50% marks must be obtained in the annual or each semester examination. In the case of students of IIT, IIM or AIIMS, the condition of marks is NOT applied, and the copy of the certificate of promotion to the next higher class is sufficient.
33. If a student FAILS to obtain 50% marks, the scholarship is STOPPED until he secures 50% marks in the next semester or annual examination. If a student is DETAINED, the scholarship is DISCONTINUED ALTOGETHER.
34. The child must be pursuing the course as a REGULAR student — not part-time, correspondence and so on — in a recognised institute or university. In case of doubt whether a particular course is to be treated as a technical degree, reference may be made to the concerned State or Central Government authority for clarification.
35. The scholarship automatically CEASES in the event of the GDS resigning from service, or being dismissed, removed or discharged on attaining the maximum prescribed age.
36. Not more than TWO CHILDREN of a GDS will be granted the scholarship, so as to ensure that a larger number of GDS are covered.
37. The maximum amount utilised towards granting scholarships in a financial year in a Region or Circle shall not exceed 20%, that is, ONE-FIFTH of the balance available in the Circle GDS fund as on 1st April of the year.

THE DISTINCTION THAT IS ALWAYS TESTED

FAILING and being DETAINED are treated differently. A student who fails to score 50% has the scholarship STOPPED — it revives when he secures 50% in the next examination. A student who is DETAINED loses it ALTOGETHER.

Equally, note the two places where IIT / IIM / AIIMS students are treated specially: no minimum marks for the initial grant, and no marks condition for renewal.

(d) Incentive for excellence in academic achievement — head 10

Five awards are instituted for children of GDS in each of four groups, purely on merit, on the basis of marks in the 10th and 12th Standard Board Examination, subject to the minimum percentage shown against each group:

Sl.	Class / group	Minimum percentage of aggregate marks
1	10th standard	85%
2	12th Standard (Science Group)	85%

Sl.	Class / group	Minimum percentage of aggregate marks
3	12th Standard (Commerce Group)	80%
4	12th Standard (Humanities Group)	80%

Table 4.14 — Annexure-B, para 5(II)(a). These GDS percentages are now verified against the order, and are not merely carried forward.

How the merit list is drawn and the awards sanctioned

- A common merit list is drawn for the units directly administered by the CPMG, and similarly a common merit list for the units falling under the charge of the Regional PMG — SEPARATELY for each, showing the percentage of marks UP TO TWO DECIMALS.
- The merit list contains the names of students of ALL BOARDS — State Board, CBSE and so on — subject to the minimum percentage fixed above.
- The first five students are sanctioned the awards: 1st – ₹ 1,100; 2nd – ₹ 880; 3rd – ₹ 770; 4th – ₹ 660; 5th – ₹ 550.
- If MORE THAN ONE student obtains the same percentage of marks for any position, ALL of them are given the awards, and the number of awards is increased accordingly.
- Applications of GDS whose children had appeared in Board examinations OUTSIDE the Circle are considered by the Circle or Region in which the GDS is working.
- The awards under this scheme should be finalised and announced BEFORE 30th SEPTEMBER each year.

(e) Scholarship for differently abled children — head 11

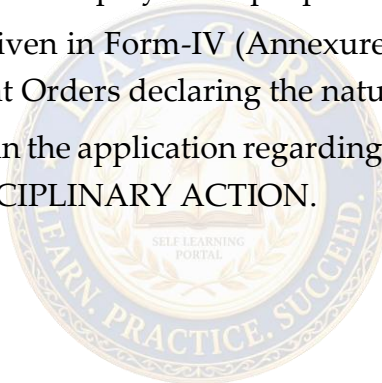
Scholarships for differently abled, mentally challenged, blind, deaf or dumb children of GDS are granted at the rate of ₹ 220 per month, subject to the following conditions:

- Granted for a maximum period of EIGHT YEARS.
- Renewed every year subject to the maximum of 8 years, provided the scholarship is not paid more than TWICE for the same class or standard. In other words, even if a child is not promoted to the next standard, the scholarship can be awarded for the FIRST REPEAT YEAR.
- Admissible to differently abled children with PERMANENT PARTIAL DISABILITY of at least 40%. However, in the case of totally blind, deaf and dumb children, NO such limit applies.
- This must be supported by a certificate from a GOVERNMENT MEDICAL OFFICER.

(f) Natural calamities — head 13

38. The assistance is to be provided only to those GDS who are seriously affected — property burnt by fire, property damaged by floods, children's books destroyed and so on.
39. All cases must be scrutinised with reference to those parameters IN ADDITION to a certificate from the REVENUE AUTHORITIES. All claims must be got verified by deputing officers of appropriate level, so as to ensure the correctness of the verification.
40. Assistance is to be granted where there has been REAL AND SUBSTANTIAL damage to property. No assistance is to be granted where there is no damage to property or books, EVEN IF the area has been declared flood-affected by the Revenue Authorities. In case of irregularities coming to notice on this count, the verifying officer may be held responsible and noticed suitably.
41. Only those GDS whose movable or immovable property has been SUBSTANTIALLY affected or damaged in an area affected by natural calamity are eligible.
42. The concerned STATE GOVERNMENT should have declared the area as having been affected by natural calamity — flood, drought, fire or cyclone — and granted a similar advance or grant to their own employees or people in the area.
43. The application must be given in Form-IV (Annexure-F) within THREE MONTHS of the date of the Government Orders declaring the natural calamity.
44. If the official's declaration in the application regarding damage to his property is found untrue, he is liable for DISCIPLINARY ACTION.

Annexure-B, para 6.



4.17 Component (ii) — The Repayable Loan Scheme

This component was substantially recast by the 2026 order. Under the scheme a GDS is eligible for a loan at a lower rate of SIMPLE interest, subject to a maximum loan amount of ₹ 1,00,000.

Sl.	Purpose of the loan	Provision
(i)	Construction of one room with flush toilet facilities for housing the Branch Post Office	₹ 50,000 @ 5%
(ii)	Purchase of a computer or laptop, to encourage computer literacy among GDS	₹ 20,000 @ 5%
(iii)	Purchase of a moped, scooter or motorcycle, to facilitate official duties such as BO bag exchange and visits to the Account Office	₹ 20,000 @ 5%
—	Purchase of ELECTRIC TWO-WHEELERS (new provision)	₹ 50,000, or 80% of the total cost of the vehicle, whichever is LESS, @ 3% simple interest
(iv)	Purchase of a mobile phone or tablet	₹ 15,000 @ 5%

Table 4.15 — Para 15.1.

THE ELECTRIC TWO-WHEELER LOAN — THE HEADLINE NEW BENEFIT

This is the only entirely new loan purpose introduced by the 2026 order, and the only item carrying the concessional 3% rate. Everything else is at 5%.

Note the twin ceiling: ₹50,000 OR 80% of the total cost, whichever is LESS. A GDS buying an electric two-wheeler costing ₹50,000 therefore gets ₹40,000 (80%), not ₹50,000. Questions are built on exactly this.

Note also that the electric two-wheeler ceiling (₹50,000) is two and a half times the ordinary two-wheeler ceiling (₹20,000) — a deliberate policy nudge towards electric vehicles.

(a) Eligibility, service conditions and repayment — the master table

Annexure-B fixes a separate set of conditions for each purpose. One condition is common to all five and can therefore be learnt once: **every loan requires a minimum of 5 years' continuous service (or, for the mobile and tablet loan, continuous engagement) as GDS.** What differs between the loans is the service that must remain, the repayment period and the surety — and those differences are precisely what is examined.

Loan purpose	Service that must REMAIN	Repayment	Surety
BO room construction — ₹ 50,000 (GDSBPM / GDSSPM only)	Minimum 8 years, i.e. age not more than 57 years	56 equated monthly instalments @ ₹ 1,000 per month	Two PERMANENT REGULAR DEPARTMENTAL OFFICIALS with more

Loan purpose	Service that must REMAIN	Repayment	Surety
			than 6 years' service left, i.e. age not more than 54
Computer / laptop — ₹ 20,000	Minimum 5 years, i.e. age not more than 60 years	21 equated monthly instalments @ ₹ 1,000 per month	Two GDS employees with more than 5 years' service left, i.e. age not more than 60
Moped / scooter / motorcycle — ₹ 20,000	Minimum 5 years, i.e. age not more than 60 years	21 equated monthly instalments @ ₹ 1,000 per month	Two GDS employees with more than 5 years' service left
Electric vehicle — ₹ 50,000 or 80% of cost	Minimum 5 years, i.e. age not more than 60 years	MAXIMUM 50 equated monthly instalments, as per the amount of loan availed	Two GDS employees with more than 5 years' service left
Mobile / tablet — ₹ 15,000	Minimum 5 years engagement left, i.e. age not more than 60 years	21 equated monthly instalments	Two GDS employees with more than 5 years' engagement left

Table 4.16 — Annexure-B, paras 7.1 to 7.4.

THE THREE TRAPS IN TABLE 4.16

1. ONLY the BO room loan requires 8 years of service left (age not more than 57). Every other loan requires 5 years left (age not more than 60). Earlier editions of these notes applied the 8-year rule to the two-wheeler and mobile loans as well — that was wrong and has been corrected.
2. ONLY the BO room loan takes DEPARTMENTAL officials as sureties, and they must have more than SIX years' service left (not more than 54 years of age). Every other loan takes two GDS employees with more than five years left.
3. The instalment counts are 56 / 21 / 21 / maximum 50 / 21 — they are NOT uniform, and they are certainly not the "25 monthly instalments" that circulate in older compilations. That figure has been removed from these notes.

(b) Conditions specific to the BO room loan

- The application is made in Form-V (Annexure-G).
- It is paid ONLY for NEW construction — not for repairs or renovation of an existing room, and not for the purchase of an already constructed room.
- The land should be available IN THE NAME OF THE BRANCH POSTMASTER. The loan amount CANNOT be utilised for the purchase of land.
- Utilising the room for any purpose other than housing the Branch Post Office is construed as irregular and attracts necessary action.

- The construction should be EXACTLY according to the approved plan and specification on the basis of which the advance was sanctioned.
- The construction should be completed within SIX MONTHS of the drawl of the loan. Extension of the time-limit up to ONE MONTH can be considered by the PMG, and beyond one month by the HEAD OF CIRCLE, if the work is delayed due to circumstances beyond the control of the GDS.
- The Branch Post Office Room is to be maintained in good condition by the GDS AT HIS COST.
- On completion of construction, the room MAY be insured by the GDS at his cost against fire, flood and lightning, for the full value of the room.
- Recovery commences from the TRCA for the month FOLLOWING the month of drawl of advance, is effected from the monthly TRCA, and CANNOT BE POSTPONED without the prior approval of the Head of Circle.

(c) Conditions specific to the vehicle and equipment loans

- The loan amount is to be utilised for the purchase of a NEW item. It shall not be used for purchase of an old or second-hand laptop, computer, moped, scooter, motorcycle or mobile.
- The loan is NOT granted if the vehicle has already been purchased and paid for. Purchase of the vehicle should be made within ONE MONTH from the date of drawl of the loan.
- For vehicles, the advance can be drawn only after receipt of a WRITTEN ASSURANCE FROM THE DEALER that the supply of the vehicle is likely to be available within a month, and a certificate to that effect is recorded on the bill for the advance.
- For the mobile or tablet, the bill must be IN THE NAME OF THE GDS.
- The vehicle CANNOT BE SOLD till repayment of principal and interest. Prior sanction of the Competent Authority is necessary to sell or transfer the vehicle before repayment of the loan with interest thereon.

(d) The penal interest clause

A copy of the bill or receipt — or, in the case of a vehicle, a copy of the Registration Certificate in the GDS's own name together with the insurance — must be produced **within one month of purchase, or within two months from the date of drawl of the loan**. Failing that, penal interest at **12% per annum** is levied from the date of drawl of the loan to the date of production of the document. In the case of the mobile or tablet loan, the order adds that penal interest is charged on the bill **and on the overdue amount for the period of default**.

Critically, if the delay in submitting the bill, receipt or RC is NOT ATTRIBUTABLE to the Gramin Dak Sevak, the penal interest is NOT to be charged for the late submission.

(e) General guidelines governing all loans

45. All regularly engaged GDS whose orders of engagement are available on record are eligible. Those GDS who have served in APS and rejoined as GDS — their PAST SERVICE IN APS is counted for eligibility.
46. The sanctioning authority should be satisfied about the GDS's likely retention or continuation in service for more than five years or eight years, as the case may be.
47. A category of GDS OTHER THAN BPMs is NOT eligible for the loan for construction of one room with flush toilet facilities for housing the Branch Post Office.
48. The loan under any of the categories specified in Para 15 will be paid ONLY ONCE in the entire working career of the GDS — read with Para 15.2, which permits a maximum of two loans in all, subject to a ceiling of ₹ 1,00,000 and full repayment of any previous loan.
49. Priority is to be given to those who have NOT availed any loan under the various categories, on the date of application.
50. The loan should NOT be sanctioned or disbursed to an official who is UNDER PUT OFF DUTY. If a loan has already been sanctioned to him before he was placed under put off duty, he should not be permitted to draw it during that period.
51. The loan is NOT admissible if any DISCIPLINARY ACTION is pending or contemplated, or any CRIMINAL CASE is pending.
52. Furnishing a FALSE CERTIFICATE renders the GDS liable to disciplinary action; he may be directed to refund the entire advance with interest, and he becomes INELIGIBLE for any assistance or loan from the GDS Welfare Fund.
53. A GDS on Leave Without Allowance draws no amount. If a loan has been paid, the recovery of the loan amount during the period of LWA has to be DEPOSITED BY THE GDS every month.

(f) Failure in repayment

Situation	How the outstanding is recovered
Quitting service by RESIGNATION before repayment	The outstanding amount, to the extent possible, is adjusted against the TRCA due, if any. Resignation may be accepted on clearance of the outstanding amount. The balance remaining unpaid is recovered FROM THE SURETY
Quitting due to MEDICAL INVALIDATION, supported by a certificate issued by a Civil Surgeon	The outstanding amount may ALSO be adjusted from the ex-gratia gratuity
Failure to repay on or before the date of retirement, or default on repayment	The Department is at liberty to enforce recovery from ex-gratia gratuity and/or from the two officials who stood as surety, and to recover the outstanding dues from the pay or

Situation	How the outstanding is recovered
	any other admissible allowances of the employees who gave sureties
UNTIMELY DEATH of the GDS	Recovered from the nominees, out of the amount of pay and allowances etc. due or accrued to the deceased GDS and payable by the Department to the nominee. Any remaining outstanding is recovered from the sureties

Table 4.17 — Annexure-B, para 9.

INSOLVENCY — A GROUND FOR OUTRIGHT REJECTION

Annexure-B expressly invokes Para 27 of the Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020, under the heading “Insolvency and habitual indebtedness”, which requires a Sevak to so manage his private affairs as to avoid habitual indebtedness or insolvency, and to report forthwith the full facts of any legal proceeding instituted for the recovery of any debt due from him or for adjudging him an insolvent.

The order then directs that while considering cases for loan under this scheme, the Committee shall keep this aspect in view and CAN REJECT THE APPLICATION ON THIS GROUND ALONE.

4.18 Component (iii) — One-Time Repayment at the Time of Retirement

A GDS who has not claimed any kind of assistance or grant from the Circle Welfare Contributory Fund in his entire service is paid a lump sum amount at the time of discharge from duty:

Sl.	Length of service from the date of start of contribution	Amount to be paid
(i)	Less than 5 years	No amount
(ii)	5 years	₹ 1,000
(iii)	10 years	₹ 2,000
(iv)	15 years	₹ 3,000
(v)	20 years	₹ 4,500
(vi)	25 years	₹ 5,500
(vii)	30 years	₹ 6,500
(viii)	35 years	₹ 8,000
(ix)	40 years	₹ 9,000
(x)	More than 45 years	₹ 11,000

Table 4.18 — Para 16.1.

HOW TO REMEMBER THIS TABLE

The increments are not uniform, and that is exactly why it is examined. Read the differences: 1000 → 2000 → 3000 (steps of 1,000), then 4500 (a step of 1,500), then 5500 → 6500 (steps of 1,000), then 8000 (a step of 1,500), then 9000 (a step of 1,000), then 11,000 (a step of 2,000).

Two entries have no slab at all: there is nothing for 45 years exactly — the last slab reads “more than 45 years” — and nothing below 5 years.

The disqualifying condition is absolute: ANY kind of assistance or grant claimed at any time in the entire service extinguishes the benefit.

4.19 Sanctions, Utilisation Ceilings and Accounting**(a) Sanctions from the fund**

- Sanction orders are issued by the Chief PMGs / Regional PMGs.
- The Regional PMGs must, at the end of the year, submit to the Chief PMG a list of officials along with the amount granted under the Circle Welfare Scheme, for information.
- In the case of payment of FUNERAL EXPENSES, the payment may be ordered by the LOCAL CONTROLLING AUTHORITY, pending ex-post-facto sanction by the competent authority.
- The Committee conveys its approval of assistance or loan through the issue of MINUTES to the Divisional Heads, and the DIVISIONAL HEADS then issue the sanction orders.

(b) Accounting procedure in the Head Post Office

54. The GDS submits the application for loan to the Head of Division, who gets it verified against Head Post Office records and Sub-Divisional or Divisional Office records, as the case may be. All applications received in a quarter are processed and decided in the CO / RO latest by the subsequent quarter.
55. The Head of Division maintains a REGISTER OF LOANS for GDS in the Divisional Office, and forwards all applications, after duly examining correctness, to the Head of Circle or Regional PMG.
56. In the CO / RO, the concerned branch submits a consolidated list of applications before the Committee, and the funds position is also brought on record.

(c) The utilisation ceilings — by head number

This is one of the most precisely examinable provisions in the whole scheme, because the ceilings are tied to the serial numbers of Para 14.1. The limits are computed on the balance as on 1st April of the year.

Purpose	Heads of Para 14.1 covered	Limit
Illness related cases	Serial Numbers 6, 7, 8 and 14	Maximum up to 25% of funds
Education related financial assistance	Serial Numbers 9, 10 and 11	Maximum up to 20% of funds
Loans during the financial year, on a first-come first-served basis	Para 15	Maximum up to 40% of the GDS Welfare Corpus, provided the Circle Welfare Fund has a minimum balance of ₹ 50.00 lakh; otherwise the limit of up to 25% may be applied
All other welfare assistance, including the Circle / Regional reserve fund for emergencies	Serial Numbers 1 to 5 and 13	THE REMAINING BALANCE

Table 4.19 — Annexure-B, para 15(c), read with Para 15.3 of the main order.

TWO CORRECTIONS TO WHAT CIRCULATES ELSEWHERE

The fourth line is NOT a fixed 30%. The order says the REMAINING BALANCE is available for all other welfare assistance. Older compilations show 30% and that figure has been removed from these notes.

Note also that COVID assistance (head 14) is grouped with ILLNESS for the purpose of the 25% ceiling — not with “all other welfare assistance”, where one might instinctively place it. Natural calamity (head 13) on the other hand IS in the residual group.

A separate provision at Annexure-B para 13 states that the approval for grant of loans during a financial year should be restricted to 25% of the balance of the fund as on 1st April. This is the ordinary limit; Para 15.3 of the main order and para 15(c)(iii) of Annexure-B both permit it to be raised to 40% where the corpus is at least ₹50 lakh.

(d) Honorarium and incentive

Functionary	Amount	Authority
Treasurer	₹ 5,000 per annum	Annexure-A, clause 12.2
Auditor	₹ 1,000 per annum	Annexure-A, clause 12.2
Dealing Assistant in the Head Post Office handling this work	₹ 3,000 per annum	Annexure-B, para 14
Supervisor in the Head Post Office handling this work	₹ 1,500 per annum	Annexure-B, para 14

Table 4.20 — The rate of honorarium payable to any person OTHER THAN the Treasurer and the Auditor may be decided by the Managing Committee (clause 12.1). Note that the Dealing Assistant and Supervisor amounts are described in the order as an INCENTIVE rather than an honorarium, and both are per annum.

4.20 Audit and Investment

Two separate audit provisions operate, one in the main body of the order and one in the bye-laws, and they must be read together rather than treated as alternatives.

Requirement	Time limit / authority	Source
Regional PMG submits to the CPMG the accounts of receipts and expenditure at the close of each financial year. The CPMG does the same for Divisions and Units under his direct control	Latest by 15th April	Para 18.1
Chief PMG sends the consolidated audited accounts for the Circle as a whole to the Director (Welfare & Sports) in the Directorate	On completion of the above	Para 18.1
Auditing work done by the IFA, O/o the Chief Postmaster General, or by any agency or officer appointed by the Managing Committee, who certifies the correctness of accounts with comments if any	Within TWO MONTHS of the end of each financial year	Annexure-A, clause 13
The auditor's report placed before the Committee soon after completion of the audit	Within THREE MONTHS of the end of the financial year	Annexure-A, clause 13
Annual audit of the accounts of the fund by the F&C Audit, or by any person authorised by the GM (F) / DAP as the case may be in the Circle	On or before 30th JUNE of each year	Para 18.3
Certificate that the GDS Welfare Fund for the year has been audited and found correct, furnished to the Postal Directorate	Within ONE MONTH of the auditing of accounts	Para 18.2
Annual check of the accounts by the Internal Check Organisation of the respective Circle	Before the Audit Inspection takes place	Para 18.4

Table 4.21 — The complete audit chain.

A CORRECTION OF OUR OWN EARLIER CORRECTION

An earlier edition of these notes stated that the provision for auditing “within 2 months of the end of each financial year by the IFA, O/o the Chief Postmaster General, or by any agency or officer appointed by the Managing Committee” had been dropped, and that Para 18 had replaced it.

That was WRONG, and it is withdrawn. On reading the full text of the order, clause 13 of Annexure-A retains that provision word for word. It coexists with Para 18 of the main body. The

IFA route is the general auditing arrangement in the bye-laws; Para 18 fixes the outer dates and names the F&C Audit for the annual audit.

Both are current. A candidate should be able to state either, and should not treat the IFA provision as superseded.

Investment of funds

Surplus funds not required for immediate utilisation may be invested to the best advantage of the fund as decided by the Managing Committee — ONLY in Government financial institutions or NATIONALISED BANKS. Annexure-A, clause 14.

The amount contributed from the TRCA of the GDS is deposited in a SEPARATE savings account. Disbursement to the GDS, after due scrutiny and approval of the competent authority, is made through the issue of sanction orders. The annual grants for the GDS category are disbursed from the Central Welfare Fund of the Directorate to the Circle Welfare Fund for GDS. Para 19.

4.21 The Seven Prescribed Forms

Orders containing provisions about the day-to-day administering of the scheme, the terms and conditions for grants and loans, and the proformas of the various applications and forms are enclosed in the annexures. The forms are worth knowing by number, because a question asking which form is used for which purpose is trivially easy to set.

Form	Annexure	Purpose
Form-I	Annexure-C	Application for JOINING the Circle Welfare Fund for Gramin Dak Sevaks
Form-II	Annexure-D	Application for FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE from the Fund
Form-III	Annexure-E	Proforma for submission of a case to the DIRECTORATE for grant of financial assistance BEYOND the powers of the PMG / CPMG in cases of illness
Form-IV	Annexure-F	Proforma for grant of financial assistance in cases of NATURAL CALAMITIES
Form-V	Annexure-G	Application for grant of LOAN for construction of one room with flush toilet facilities for housing the Branch Post Office
Form-VI	Annexure-H	FORM OF SURETY BOND
Form-VII	Annexure-I	Application for grant of LOAN for purchase of moped / scooter / motor cycle / ELECTRIC VEHICLE / laptop / computer / mobile / tablet

Table 4.22 — The forms. Note that Form-VII covers ALL FOUR of the non-construction loans, while the BO room loan has its own Form-V.

WHAT FORM-I ASKS FOR

The joining application asks for ten particulars: name of GDS; date of birth; DATE OF COMPLETION OF 65 YEARS OF AGE; designation; full address of the office where working; TRCA being drawn; name of Account Office and name of Head Post Office; name of Sub Division; date of appointment; and whether regular appointment orders are available, with a copy enclosed.

The declaration on the form binds the GDS to abide by all future decisions taken in the matter, issued by way of any amendment, clarification or modification to the Scheme by the Department of Posts. Membership is then formally accepted or not accepted by the Divisional Head or Unit Head.

The presence of “date of completion of 65 years of age” on the form is the administrative counterpart of clause 3.4 — membership must cease on that date.



PART 5 — DEPARTMENTAL EMPLOYEE VS GDS: THE CONSOLIDATED COMPARISON

This Part exists purely for revision. Everything here has already appeared above; the value lies in seeing the two columns side by side, because that is the form in which the topic is almost always tested. Every figure in both columns is now verified against the order that fixes it.

Benefit	Departmental Employee	Gramin Dak Sevak
Immediate assistance on death	₹ 25,000	₹ 11,000
Death by attack — robbers, terrorists, riots, extremist activity — ON duty	₹ 1,10,000	₹ 1,65,000
Death by attack — NOT on duty	₹ 35,000	₹ 13,200
Death on duty due to accident	₹ 35,000	₹ 27,500
Funeral expenses	Not provided	₹ 5,500
Natural calamity, fire, flood	₹ 4,500 ○	₹ 5,500
Prolonged illness / major surgery	₹ 15,000	₹ 30,000
Accident on duty needing hospitalisation over 3 days	Not a separate head	₹ 5,500
TB nutritional diet — indoor / outdoor	₹ 400 / ₹ 200 p.m. ○ (self and family)	₹ 440 / ₹ 220 p.m. (self only)
COVID-19 assistance	Not a separate head in this scheme	₹ 50,000
Scholarship — disabled / specially abled child	₹ 750 p.m.	₹ 220 p.m.
Transport charges — 'A' class / other city	₹ 450 / ₹ 375 p.m.	Not provided
Hostel / mess subsidy — 'A' class / other city	₹ 300 / ₹ 250 p.m. ○	Not provided
Scholarship — IIT / AIIMS / IIM	₹ 1,500 p.m.	₹ 1,100 p.m.
Scholarship — technical / medical degree	₹ 1,200 p.m.	₹ 308 p.m.
Scholarship — technical / medical diploma	₹ 450 p.m.	₹ 209 p.m.

Benefit	Departmental Employee	Gramin Dak Sevak
Scholarship — non-technical degree	₹ 375 p.m. (GIRL students only, no minimum percentage)	₹ 165 p.m. (minimum 80%)
Scholarship — ITI certificate	₹ 2,100 p.a.	₹ 1,034 p.a. (minimum 65%)
Academic excellence — 1st position	₹ 9,000	₹ 1,100
Academic excellence — 5th position	₹ 4,500	₹ 550
Qualifying marks — Class 10	90% in all subjects (relaxable to 80%)	85%
Qualifying marks — Class 12 Science	90% in all subjects (relaxable to 80%)	85%
Qualifying marks — Class 12 Commerce / Humanities	90% in all subjects (relaxable to 80%)	80%
Repayable loan	Not available	Up to ₹ 1,00,000 @ 5% or 3%
Retirement benefit for non-claimants	Not available	₹ 1,000 to ₹ 11,000
Subscription payable by the individual	Nil	₹ 40 p.m. / ₹ 480 p.a.

Table 5.1 — Master comparison. ○ marks the three departmental figures that were not revised on 22.12.2025 and continue under Para VII of that order. Everything else in the departmental column is a revised rate effective 01.04.2026.

THE FOUR PLACES WHERE THE GDS RATE BEATS THE DEPARTMENTAL RATE

1. Death by attack while on duty — ₹1,65,000 against ₹1,10,000.
2. Natural calamity, fire and flood — ₹5,500 against ₹4,500.
3. Prolonged illness and major surgery — ₹30,000 against ₹15,000.
4. TB nutritional diet — ₹440 / ₹220 against ₹400 / ₹200. But note the offsetting difference: the departmental scheme covers the employee AND family members, the GDS scheme is for treatment of SELF ONLY.

Everywhere else the departmental rate is higher. If a question offers a GDS figure larger than the departmental figure and the head is not one of the four above, suspect the option.

THE UNITS TRAP IN THE SCHOLARSHIP ROWS

In the education table, the ITI slab is expressed PER ANNUM in both columns while every other slab is per month. A candidate who reads ₹2,100 as a monthly figure will conclude that ITI is the most generous departmental scholarship, when in fact at ₹175 a month it is by far the least.

The same applies to the GDS column: ₹1,034 per annum is about ₹86 a month, well below the ₹165 monthly non-technical rate.

PART 6 – CURRENCY AUDIT OF THIS EDITION

This Part is the record of the verification exercise carried out before this edition was released. It is set out openly so that the reader can judge for himself how much weight to place on each figure, and so that the corrections made are traceable.

THE STATE OF VERIFICATION

Both governing orders have been read in full, including every annexure: the departmental revision O.M. No. 1-01/2024-WI&Sps dated 22.12.2025 with its Annexure-A (list of technical courses) and Annexure-B (RWA conditions); and the CWFGDS O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.02.2026 with its Annexure-A (bye-laws), Annexure-B (guidelines, terms and conditions) and Annexures C to I (Forms I to VII).

Consequently this edition carries no unconfirmed figures. Where a figure was not revised on 22.12.2025 it is flagged ○ and its continuing force rests on Para VII of that order.

6.1 Corrections Arising from the Departmental Revision of 22.12.2025

Item	What earlier editions said	Corrected position	Authority
Existence of the order	The amending order of 22.12.2025 was cited on the cover but could not be traced, and all departmental rates were flagged unconfirmed	The order exists and has been read in full. It conveys the decisions of the 13th PSSWB meeting held on 11.11.2025 and takes effect from 01.04.2026	O.M. No. 1-01/2024-WI&Sps
Education scholarship – rows scrambled	Diploma ₹375 p.m.; non-technical degree ₹2,100 p.a.; ITI ₹450 p.m.	Diploma ₹450 p.m.; non-technical degree ₹375 p.m.; ITI ₹2,100 p.a. The three figures were genuine but attached to the wrong rows	Para III(b)
Non-technical degree – who is eligible	No restriction stated	GIRL STUDENTS ONLY, undergoing graduation in any field	Para III(b)
Non-technical degree – marks condition	Not stated	The earlier requirement of 60% aggregate in Class 12 has been REMOVED; the revised provision reads “irrespective of minimum percentage”	Para III(b)
Overlap of scholarships	Not mentioned	If any girl is eligible for multiple scholarships, the HIGHER will be paid	Para III(b)

Item	What earlier editions said	Corrected position	Authority
Academic excellence — marks condition	90% aggregate	Minimum 90% marks IN ALL THE SUBJECTS, relaxable to 80% where a position cannot be filled	Note to Para III(a)
SC/ST scholarship — coverage	Described as an SC/ST scheme	The scheme now covers SC / ST / OBC employees	Para III(c)
SC/ST/OBC higher education	Described as ₹4,500 per annum restricted to fee paid	It is a ONE-TIME GRANT covering a specified amount of tuition fees, books or other related expenses	Para III(c)
Earmarked allocation for scholarships	Not mentioned	May be revised from 55% to 60%, if necessary	Note to Para III(c)
Hostel / mess subsidy	Shown at ₹450 / ₹375 alongside transport	NOT revised. Transport rose to ₹450 / ₹375; hostel and mess subsidy remain ₹300 / ₹250	Para III(d)
Excursion trip — short option	200 km BOTH SIDES once a year	200 km ONE-SIDED, TWICE in a year. The long option is 1,000 km one-sided once a year	Para V
Excursion trip — subsidy	75%, with no earlier figure	Raised from 60% to 75%. Both figures are examinable	Para V
Holiday home rent	Stated without qualification	The revised rent is expressly for ONE SUITE ONLY. Rates rose from ₹40 to ₹60 and from ₹100 to ₹150 per day	Para VI(a)
Departmental illness / surgery	₹15,000 flagged unconfirmed	Verified: raised from ₹10,000 to ₹15,000. The GDS figure rose from ₹22,000 to ₹30,000 in the same paragraph	Para II
RWA conditions	Only the 200-member rule and the relaxation were known	A full set of ten conditions is prescribed at Annexure-B, covering women members, sources of income, chowkidar funds, control by the Divisional Head, vacancy filling, the two-thirds cap, elections, joint bank signatures, the bar on external affiliation, and disciplinary action for political activity	Annexure-B

Item	What earlier editions said	Corrected position	Authority
		under the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964	

Table 6.1 — Corrections arising from the departmental revision.

6.2 Corrections Arising from the CWFGDS of 11.02.2026

Item	What earlier editions said	Corrected position	Authority
Commencement	Scheme in force w.e.f. 01.07.2024	That scheme is superseded. The present scheme commences from the date of issue, 11.02.2026, and supersedes all previous orders about GDS	Opening para; Para 6; Annexure-B para 17
Maximum repayable loan	₹ 50,000	₹ 1,00,000	Paras 15.1, 15.2
Mobile / tablet loan	₹ 10,000	₹ 15,000	Para 15.1(iv)
Rate of interest	Single rate of 5%	Two rates — 5% ordinarily, 3% for the electric two-wheeler	Paras 13(ii), 15.1
Electric two-wheeler loan	Absent	₹ 50,000 or 80% of the cost of the vehicle, whichever is less, at 3% simple interest	Para 15.1; Annexure-B para 7.3(a)
Loan repayment period	25 monthly instalments for all loans	NOT uniform — 56 instalments for the BO room; 21 for computer, two-wheeler and mobile; maximum 50 for the electric vehicle	Annexure-B paras 7.1 to 7.4
Service-left condition	8 years left (age 57) for BO room, two-wheeler and mobile; 5 years (age 60) for computer	ONLY the BO room requires 8 years left (age 57). Computer, two-wheeler, electric vehicle and mobile all require 5 years left (age 60)	Annexure-B paras 7.1 to 7.4
Surety	Not stated	BO room — two PERMANENT REGULAR DEPARTMENTAL officials with more than 6 years' service left (age not more than 54). All other loans — two GDS employees with more than 5 years left	Annexure-B paras 7.1 to 7.4

Item	What earlier editions said	Corrected position	Authority
Major surgery grant for GDS	₹30,000 flat	₹22,000 up to 31.03.2026 and ₹30,000 w.e.f. 01.04.2026	Para 14.1(6)
Quarterly meeting cycle	Only three quarters listed	Complete four-quarter cycle — October to December applications are decided in January	Para 8.4
Immediate release without waiting	Understood as funeral expenses only	BOTH Sl. No. 1 (immediate death relief ₹11,000) and Sl. No. 5 (funeral expenses ₹5,500) may be released immediately by Divisional Heads	Annexure-B para 3(i)
The once-only rule	Stated as absolute	It CAN BE WAIVED for natural calamity and major surgical operations by the Management Committee in really deserving cases	Annexure-B para 6(vii)
Utilisation ceiling — residual	30% for all other welfare assistance	The order says THE REMAINING BALANCE, not a fixed 30%. Illness 25% (heads 6, 7, 8, 14); education 20% (heads 9, 10, 11); loans 40% or 25%; the rest is residual (heads 1 to 5 and 13)	Annexure-B para 15(c)
Managing Committee composition	Carried forward and flagged unconfirmed	Confirmed. Note that the Regional Members are “NOMINATED GDS / GDS Staff Union member”, wider than the Circle formulation	Annexure-A clauses 10.1, 10.3
Honorarium	Treasurer ₹5,000; Auditor ₹1,000; Dealing Assistant ₹3,000; Supervisor ₹1,500 — all unconfirmed	All four confirmed. The Dealing Assistant and Supervisor amounts are described as an INCENTIVE and both are per annum	Annexure-A clause 12; Annexure-B para 14
Membership termination	Reported but unconfirmed	Confirmed — non-recovery for six continuous months without valid reason terminates membership. Non-recovery attributable to the GDS attracts penal interest of ₹1 per month per instalment	Annexure-A clause 3.4

Item	What earlier editions said	Corrected position	Authority
GDS academic percentages	Carried forward and flagged	Confirmed — 85% for Class 10 and Class 12 Science; 80% for Commerce and Humanities	Annexure-B para 5(II)(a)
Maternity grant to a woman GDS	Not mentioned	Shown as DELETED, having been overridden by O.M. No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 27.06.2018	Para 14.1(12)
Statistics	Not stated	As on 31.03.2024 there were 2,67,836 GDS managing 1,39,891 Branch Post Offices	Para 2

Table 6.2 — Corrections arising from the CWFGDS.

6.3 A Correction We Made That Was Itself Wrong

WITHDRAWN — THE AUDIT PROVISION

An earlier edition of these notes asserted that the provision for auditing “within 2 months of the end of each financial year by the IFA, O/o the Chief Postmaster General, or by any agency or officer appointed by the Managing Committee” had been dropped, and had been replaced by the dates in Para 18 of the main order. That assertion was published as a correction.

It was wrong. Clause 13 of Annexure-A to the O.M. dated 11.02.2026 retains that provision word for word, and adds that the auditor’s report shall be placed before the Committee soon after completion of the audit, i.e. within three months of the end of the financial year.

The two provisions coexist. Para 18 fixes the outer dates — accounts to the CPMG by 15 April, annual audit by the F&C Audit or a person authorised by the GM (F) / DAP on or before 30 June, and the audit certificate to the Directorate within one month of audit. Annexure-A clause 13 provides the general internal auditing arrangement through the IFA.

The earlier correction is withdrawn. Table 4.21 sets out the full chain with both provisions in place. This is recorded here rather than quietly amended, because a reader who learnt the earlier version needs to know it was mistaken.

6.4 A Numbering Slip in the Order Itself

Readers working directly from the order should be aware of one internal inconsistency. Annexure-B, para 6 is headed as governing “serial numbers (12) of Para-14.1”, but the conditions it then sets out are plainly those for **natural calamities**, which is serial number 13. Serial number 12 is the deleted maternity grant, which has no conditions at all. This is a drafting slip in the order and not a substantive provision; the conditions attach to the natural calamity head. Similarly, the utilisation ceiling table at para 15(c) correctly places head 13 in the residual group, confirming the reading.

This is noted for completeness and because a candidate reading the bare order may otherwise be confused. It does not affect any figure.

6.5 What Remains Outside These Notes

For candour, three things are deliberately not reproduced here:

- 57. The full text of the surety bond at Form-VI (Annexure-H). It is a formal legal instrument several pages long. Its examinable content — who may stand surety, and how recovery is enforced against them — is set out in Tables 4.16 and 4.17.
- 58. The field-by-field content of Forms II to V and VII. Their purposes are tabulated at Table 4.22, which is the level at which the topic is examined.
- 59. The Field Service (Postal) Benevolent Fund rates at Part 2. That Fund was not among the schemes revised on 22.12.2025, and no separate current order fixing its rates was among the documents examined. The rates are shown as ○ unrevised on that footing.



PART 7 — QUICK REVISION CAPSULE

7.1 Money Figures Worth Memorising

Figure	What it is
₹ 40 / ₹ 480	GDS subscription — per month and per annum
₹ 1 per month	Penal interest per instalment where non-recovery of subscription is attributable to the GDS
₹ 200	Grant-in-aid per GDS per year from the Central Welfare Fund
₹ 22,560	Lifetime contribution of a GDS serving 47 years (18 to 65)
₹ 11,000	GDS immediate death relief — and also the top retirement slab
₹ 25,000	Departmental immediate death relief (was ₹ 10,000)
₹ 1,65,000	GDS death by attack ON duty — the highest single grant in either scheme
₹ 1,10,000	Departmental employee, same situation (was ₹ 75,000)
₹ 35,000	Departmental — BOTH death on duty by accident AND death by attack off duty (each was ₹ 15,000)
₹ 13,200 / ₹ 27,500	GDS death by attack off duty / GDS death on duty by accident
₹ 5,500	Three GDS heads — funeral expenses, accident hospitalisation over 3 days, and natural calamity
₹ 15,000 / ₹ 30,000	Illness and major surgery — departmental / GDS, both w.e.f. 01.04.2026
₹ 22,000	The GDS surgery rate up to 31.03.2026 — now superseded, but still an examinable distractor
₹ 50,000	GDS COVID assistance; also the BO room loan and the electric vehicle loan ceiling
₹ 1,00,000	Maximum GDS loan in the entire career; also the holiday home common-room furnishing ceiling
₹ 50.00 lakh	Minimum Circle Welfare Fund balance for the 40% loan-sanction relaxation
₹ 9,000 / ₹ 4,500	Departmental academic excellence, 1st and 5th position (were ₹ 6,000 and ₹ 3,000)
₹ 1,100 / ₹ 550	GDS academic excellence, 1st and 5th position
₹ 2,700 / ₹ 1,800 / ₹ 1,350	SC/ST/OBC departmental examination scholarship — IPO-IRM-AAO / Jr. Accountant-UDC / PA-SA-Sorter

Figure	What it is
₹ 77,900	Basic pay ceiling — specially abled children benefits
₹ 65,200	Basic pay ceiling — excursion trips
₹ 44,900	Basic pay ceiling — personality development scholarship
₹ 35,400	Level 6 of the 7th CPC — the dividing line for holiday home rent (₹ 60 / ₹ 150 per day)

7.2 Percentages, Counts and Time Limits

Number	What it governs
3%	Simple interest on the electric vehicle loan
5%	Simple interest on all other GDS loans
12%	Penal interest for non-production of the bill, receipt or RC
20%	Ceiling on education-related assistance from the GDS fund (heads 9, 10, 11); also one-fifth of the balance as on 1 April
25%	Ceiling on illness-related cases (heads 6, 7, 8, 14); also the ordinary loan-sanction ceiling
40%	Loan-sanction ceiling where the corpus is at least ₹ 50 lakh; also the minimum disability for the specially abled child scholarship
50%	Marks needed for RENEWAL of a scholarship; also the tricycle assistance cap
55% to 60%	The earmarked departmental allocation for scholarships, which may be revised if necessary
60%	Marks for the UPSC scholarship and the SC/ST/OBC higher education scholarship; also the OLD excursion subsidy
65% / 80% / 85%	GDS scholarship qualifying marks — ITI / non-technical degree / technical degree and diploma
75%	Excursion subsidy; artificial limb (max ₹ 2,000); personality development fee (max ₹ 2,000)
80%	Cost cap on the electric vehicle loan; the relaxed departmental academic percentage; GDS Class 12 Commerce and Humanities
85%	GDS Class 10 and Class 12 Science
90%	Departmental academic excellence — IN ALL SUBJECTS
Two occasions	Maximum number of GDS loans in the entire career

Number	What it governs
Two children	Maximum per GDS for scholarship; maximum per employee for crèche admission
Two decimals	Precision to which the academic merit list is drawn
Three officers	Minimum size of the RO / CO scrutiny committee
Three days	Hospitalisation threshold for the GDS accident grant — must be MORE than three days
Three months	Time-limit to apply for TB assistance after detection; and to apply after Government Orders declaring a natural calamity
Six months	Maximum TB assistance; time-limit to complete BO room construction; non-recovery period that terminates membership
Six years	Minimum GDS service for the TB grant; minimum service left for a departmental surety on the BO room loan
Eight years	Maximum period of the specially abled child scholarship; minimum service left for the BO room loan
21 / 50 / 56	Loan instalments — computer, two-wheeler and mobile / electric vehicle (maximum) / BO room
65 years	Maximum age of GDS service; membership ceases on that date

7.3 Dates to Remember

Date	Significance
17.09.2013	Welfare scheme of GDS bifurcated from that of departmental employees — letter No. 19-31/2012-WL & Sports
22.08.2017	12th meeting of the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board
31.01.2018	The general revision of welfare schemes that fixed the rates now superseded — O.M. No. 1-01/2017-WL & Sports
27.06.2018	O.M. No. 17-31/2016-GDS of the Establishment Division which overrode the maternity grant
15.09.2021	Order No. 20-8/2020-WL & Sports — GDS COVID assistance of ₹ 50,000
31.03.2024	Reference date for the GDS strength and BO figures quoted in the 2026 scheme
11.09.2024	The superseded CWFGDS Office Memorandum
11.11.2025	13th meeting of the PSSWB, at the Conference Hall, Block No. 10, Jodhpur Hostel, New Delhi

Date	Significance
22.12.2025	KEY DATE — O.M. No. 1-01/2024-Wl&Sps revising the departmental welfare schemes
10.02.2026	Concurrence of the JS & FA to the revised CWFGDS
11.02.2026	KEY DATE — the revised CWFGDS, effective from the date of issue
01.04.2026	The date the departmental revisions took effect; also the date the GDS surgery grant rose from ₹ 22,000 to ₹ 30,000
1st April	Date as on which the Regional fund balance is intimated and the utilisation ceilings are computed
15th April	Regional PMG submits accounts of receipts and expenditure to the CPMG
30th June	Outer date for the annual audit of the GDS Welfare Fund
30th September	Outer date for finalising and announcing the academic excellence awards

7.4 The Traps — Where Candidates Actually Lose Marks

TWELVE RECURRING TRAPS

1. Applying a departmental rate to a GDS, or the reverse. Read the stem twice.
2. Assuming the departmental rate is always higher. It is not — see the four exceptions at the end of Part 5.
3. Quoting a pre-revision departmental rate. ₹10,000 death relief, ₹6,000 first prize, ₹1,000 IIT scholarship and 60% excursion subsidy were all correct until 31.03.2026 and are wrong now.
4. Answering “01.07.2024” for the commencement of the CWFGDS. That scheme is superseded.
5. Answering ₹50,000 for the maximum GDS loan. It is now ₹1,00,000.
6. Saying all GDS loans are repaid in 25 instalments. They are 56, 21, 21, maximum 50 and 21 respectively.
7. Applying the 8-year service-left rule to loans other than the BO room loan. Only that one loan carries it.
8. Forgetting the fourth quarter of the meeting cycle — October to December applications are decided in January.
9. Reading “hospitalisation for three days” instead of “more than three days”.
10. Mixing up the electric vehicle ceiling. It is ₹50,000 OR 80% of the cost, whichever is LESS.
11. Confusing per-month with per-annum in the scholarship tables. The ITI slab is per annum in BOTH columns.
12. Treating the departmental non-technical degree scholarship as open to all students. It is for GIRL STUDENTS ONLY.

7.5 A Ten-Line Summary of the Whole Topic

60. Postal welfare runs in two streams — departmental employees under the Circle Welfare Fund, and GDS under the CWFGDS.
61. Policy is set by the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board chaired by the Minister of Communications; implementation is by the Circle Welfare Board under the Head of Circle.
62. The departmental stream is non-contributory; the GDS stream is contributory at ₹40 per month plus ₹200 per GDS per year of central grant-in-aid.
63. The departmental rates were revised at the 13th PSSWB meeting on 11.11.2025, conveyed on 22.12.2025 and effective from 01.04.2026; anything that order did not touch continues under its Para VII.
64. The GDS scheme was recast entirely by the O.M. dated 11.02.2026, which superseded the scheme of 11.09.2024 and all previous GDS orders.
65. The CWFGDS has three components — fourteen heads of non-repayable grant, a repayable loan facility, and a one-time retirement payment for those who never claimed.
66. The maximum loan is ₹1,00,000, available twice in a career, at 5% simple interest, or 3% for an electric vehicle, with surety and defined instalment counts.
67. Applications are decided quarterly on a first-come first-served basis by a committee of at least three officers, with at least two GDS representatives; death relief, funeral expenses and calamity cases need not wait for the quarter.
68. The Head of Region decides Regional grant cases; the Head of Circle is the final and coordinating authority; only the DG (Postal Services) can alter the scope of the scheme.
69. Fund utilisation is capped at 25% for illness, 20% for education and 40% or 25% for loans, with the remaining balance for everything else, all computed on the balance as on 1st April.

SOURCES CONSULTED FOR THIS EDITION

Listed so that every figure in this booklet can be traced back and re-checked by the reader.

The two governing orders, read in full including all annexures

- Department of Posts, Welfare & Sports Section, O.M. No. 1-01/2024-WL&Sps dated 22.12.2025 — Revision in Welfare Schemes for Departmental Employee / GDS, conveying the decisions of the 13th meeting of the Postal Services Staff Welfare Board held on 11.11.2025, with effect from 1st April 2026. With Annexure-A (list of technical degree and diploma courses) and Annexure-B (conditions governing Residents' Welfare Associations). The governing order for Part 3.
- Department of Posts, Welfare & Sports Section, O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.02.2026 — Circle Welfare Fund for Gramin Dak Sevaks (CWFGDS). With Annexure-A (bye-laws), Annexure-B (guidelines, terms and conditions for grant of financial assistance and grant of loan), and Annexures C to I (Forms I to VII). The governing order for Part 4.

Instruments referred to within those two orders

- O.M. No. 20-09/2019-WL & Sports dated 11.09.2024 — the superseded CWFGDS scheme.
- O.M. No. 1-01/2017-WL & Sports dated 31.01.2018 — the previous general revision of welfare schemes, following the 12th PSSWB meeting of 22.08.2017. Cited as the source of the “existing provisions” column throughout the 2025 order.
- Letters No. 2-1/2001-WL/Sports dated 26.04.2002, No. 1-01/2009-WL/Sports dated 19.03.2013 and No. 1-3/99-WL/SPT dated 01.06.2000 — earlier death-assistance instruments.
- Directorate letters No. 15-43/92-WL & Sports dated 02.09.1992, No. 10-31/98-WL & Sports dated 11.03.1999 and No. 19-31/2012-WL/Sps dated 17.09.2013 — earlier illness and surgery instruments, and the bifurcation of the GDS scheme.
- Letters No. 15016-1/86-WL & Sports dated 30.07.1990, No. 13-1/93-WL & Sports dated 20.05.1993, No. 24-46/90-WL/Sports dated 10.04.1991, No. 1-19/97-WL & Sports and No. 1-20/1997-WL & Sports both dated 17.09.1997 — earlier scholarship and specially abled children instruments.
- Letters No. 19-2/90-WL & Sports dated 11.07.1990 and No. 1-19/97-WL/Sp dated 01.06.2000 — earlier excursion trip instruments.
- Letter No. 1-1/2017-WL/Sports dated 12.03.2019 — Guidelines for Holiday Homes, of which sub-paragraphs (vii), (viii) and (ix) of paragraph III were revised.
- Order No. 20-8/2020-WL & Sports dated 15.09.2021 — COVID-19 assistance to GDS.

- Letter No. 15-1/2016-WL & Sp dated 29.08.2018 read with O.M. No. 17-31/2016-GDS dated 27.06.2018 — deletion of the maternity grant head.
- Department of Posts Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2020 — for the definition of “family”, for leave without allowance, and for Para 27 on insolvency and habitual indebtedness.
- CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 — invoked by Annexure-B to the 2025 order for disciplinary action against RWA office-bearers involved in political activity.

A NOTE ON METHOD

No figure has been carried into this edition merely because it appeared in an earlier edition. Every figure has been traced to the paragraph of the order that fixes it, and cited there.

Where an earlier edition of these notes was wrong, the error is recorded in Part 6 rather than quietly amended — including one instance where a correction we ourselves published was itself mistaken and has now been withdrawn.

Nothing has been invented, and no citation has been supplied that was not actually read.



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